

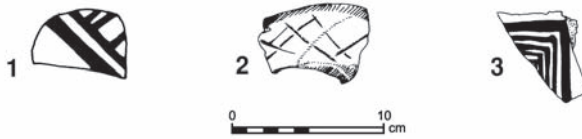
Peles; a dirt road from Hemdat to Kh. es-Suweideh passes next to it.

A shard scatter is found over an open area lacking any structural remains. In the cross-sections created

by army trenches, levels of settlement are visible, including ash.

Pottery: MA – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



498. Pottery from Peles (1), all MA: 1, 3. Dec, br on wh; 2. A *stucco* handle, gray.



499. Shard scatters at the site of Peles (1).

Site 245: 20 – 18/15/1

el-'Arquv

Israel grid: 2011 1855

UTM grid: 7395 5726

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 0.2 dunam (0.05 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), 1 km distant

Visibility: 5

Jun. 10, 1988; 12 shards

* * *

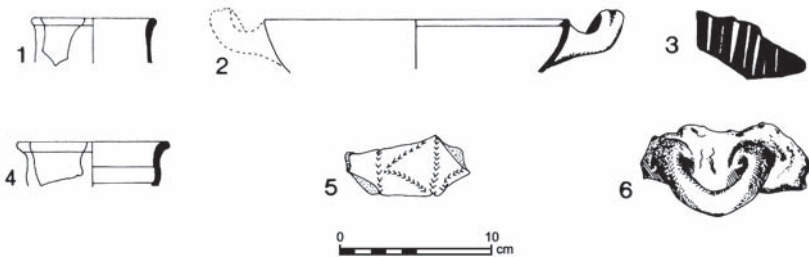
A small site in a hard, rocky area, about 3 km east-southeast of Peles.

Remnants of a wall or two, without any clear plan, were found on a wide ridge. Shard scatters and a pile

of building stones were also found. This was presumably a farm or single structure.

Pottery: Byz – 50%; MA – 50%.

Previous surveys: none.



500. Pottery from el-'Arquv: nos. 1-4, 6 – Byz; 5 – MA: 1, 4. Jars, br; 2. 'Frying pan', lt br; 3. Dec, wh on bl; 5. stucco handle, lt; 6. 'Frying pan' handle, br.

Site 246: 19 – 18/94/1

Abu Sha'areh

Israel grid: 1992 1849

UTM grid: 7372 5772

Elevation: 115 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small farm

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-
Hilu (C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 3

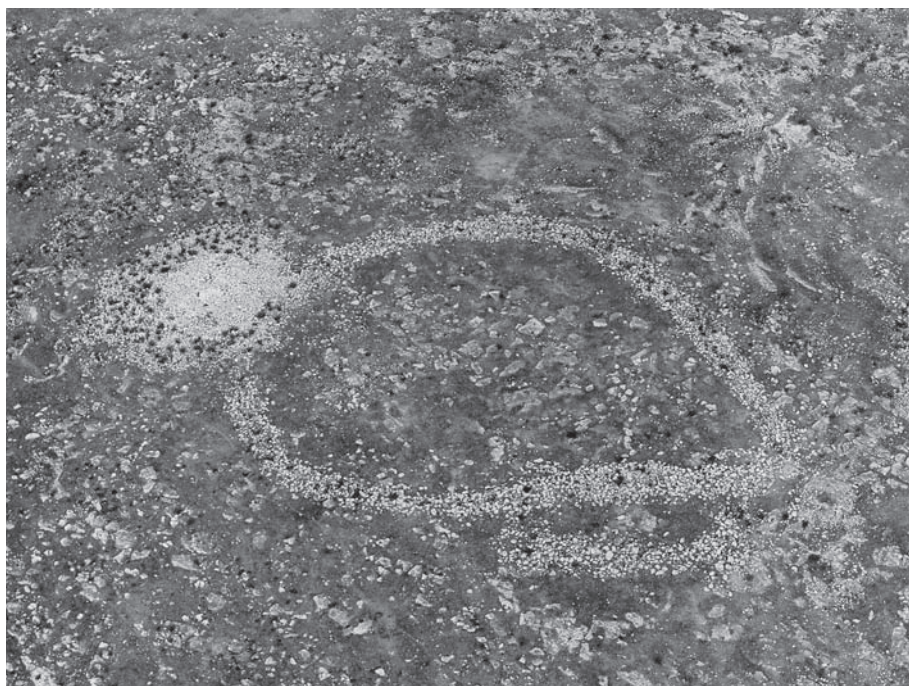
Apr. 7, 1989; May 5, 1989; 49 shards
and 13 flint items

* * *

A site on a broad hilltop, about 1 km northwest of Hemdat and 1.5 km southeast of Peles. The road to Peles passes 0.2 km to the south.

In the center of the site is an el-

liptical courtyard with a sharp tip, 35x45 m in size and surrounded by a well-built wall of medium-sized stones, 1 m wide on the average. A rectangular structure, about



501. Aerial photo of the farm of Abu Sha'areh.

5x16 m in size, is adjacent to the outside of the courtyard wall in the south. Nearby the wall widens to ca. 4 m, covering possible rooms. East of these a built entrance with a small tower are discerned. In the western part of the courtyard is a pile of stones, 10x13 m in diameter, which apparently covers the remains of a dwelling place, with remains of walls emerging. The two arms of the courtyard connect up to this pile of stones.

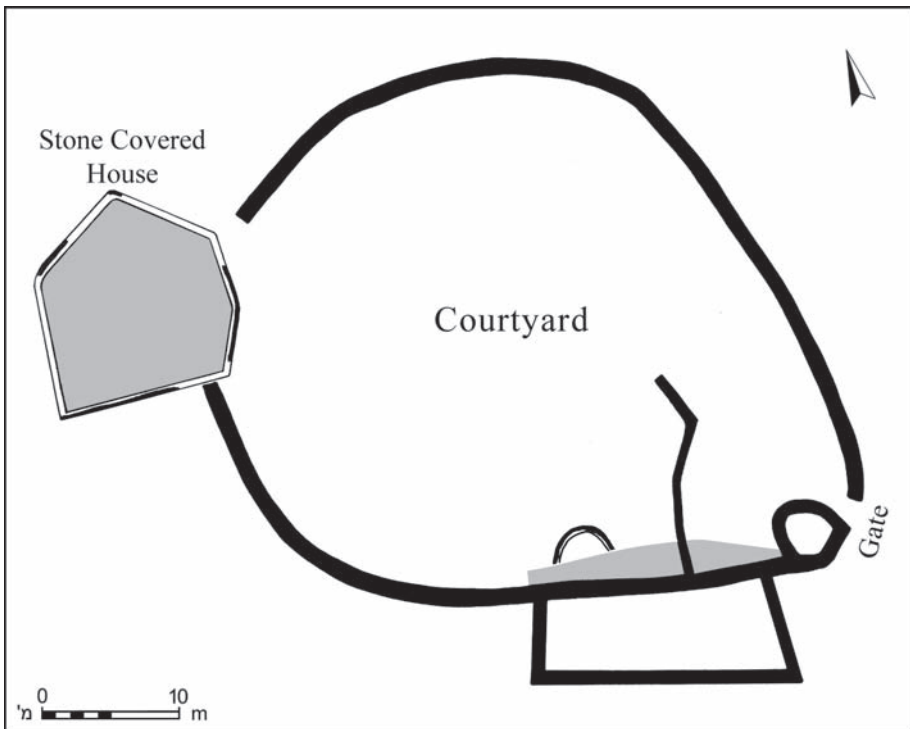
The many shards collected are from the Late Iron Age, mainly from the 7th-6th centuries B.C.E. In the Byzantine Period possibly the site was in use, presumably related agriculture in the area.

Pottery: IrA II – 30%; IrA III – 50%; Byz – 20%.

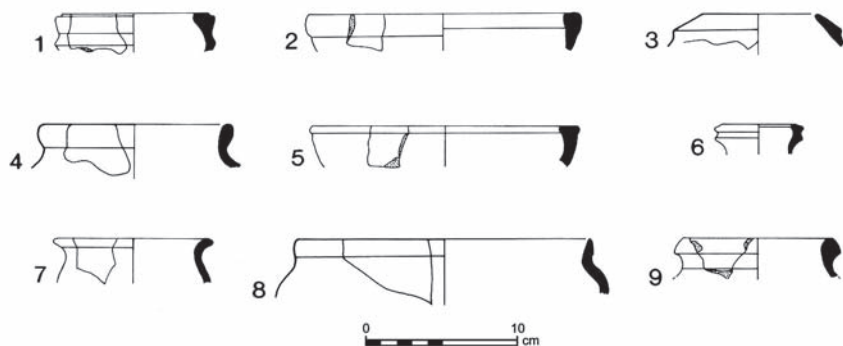
Flint find: unidentified; see appendix.

Special find: two shards from EBA I.

Previous surveys: none.



502. Plan of the Iron Age farm of Abu Sha'areh. Note the unusual shape of the courtyard.



503. Pottery from Abu Sha'areh, from IrA II-III unless otherwise noted: 1. Jar, gay; 2. Bowl, yel/br; 3. HM jar, br; 4. Bowl, br, Byz; 5. Bowl, br; 6. Juglet, gray/br; 7. Bowl, bl; 8. Bowl, br; 9. Jar, dk.



504. The Iron Age farm of Abu Sha'areh, looking northwest. The figure stands on the central structure. In the background is the hill of Umm Zoqeh (Peles).

Site 247: 19 – 18/94/2

Hemdat

Israel grid: 1995 1845

UTM grid: 7390 5716

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small farm

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: hilltop on plateau

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 3.5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 3 km distant

Visibility: 5

May 5, 1989; 22 shards

* * *

A small site on a wide hilltop, about 0.3 km northwest of the settlement of Hemdat.

A small structure, 5x6 m in size, with straight and curved walls together. Its wall is 1 m wide and built of hewn stones. West of the site are

indistinct remains of a courtyard (?) and additional walls.

The site seems to compose the remains of a farm.

Pottery: IrA II – 30%; Byz – 70%.

Special find: Ott pipe stem.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 248: 20 – 18/14/1

'Iraq Abu Hashish (A)

Israel grid: 2011 1843

UTM grid: 7394 5714

Elevation: 35 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: fortress

Area: 3.6 dunams (0.9 acre)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 1 km distant

Visibility: 6

May 25, 1990; Jun. 1, 1990; two shards

* * *

An unfinished, half-built fortress on a broad, secluded hilltop next to

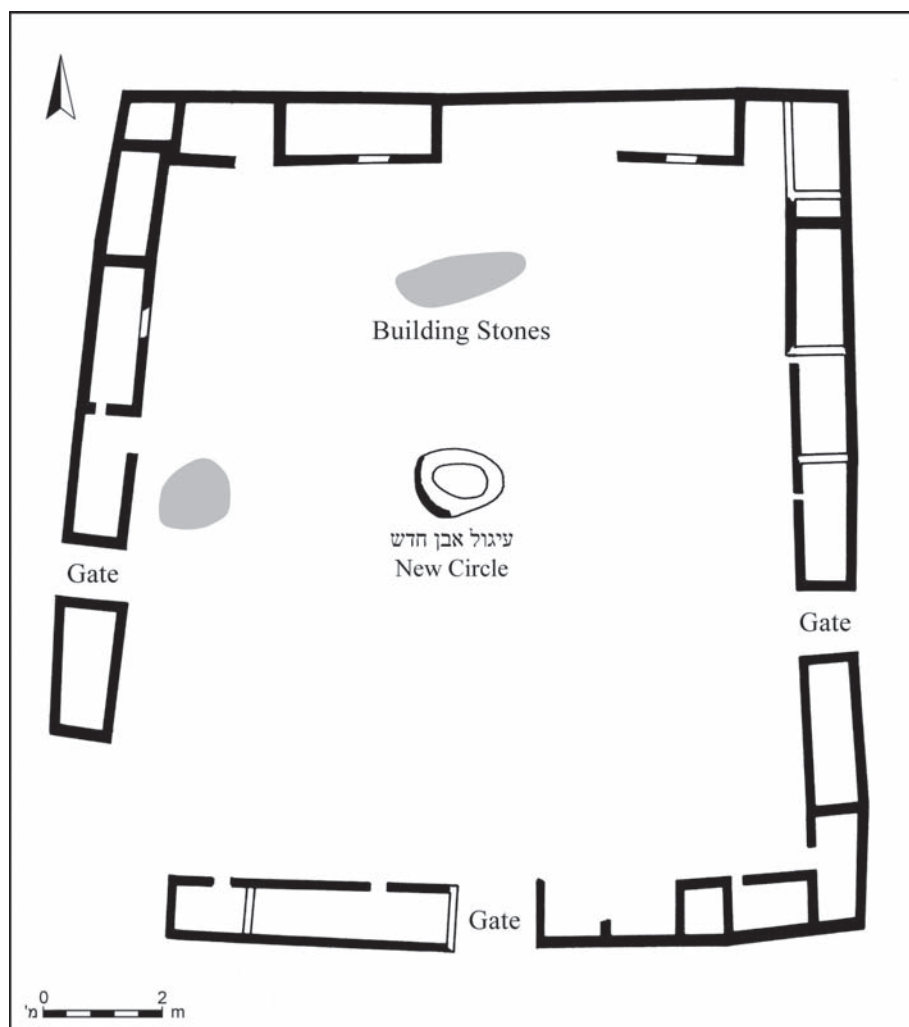
wadis, on the lowest step of the 'Arquv Range, with a fine view of the

Jordan Valley.

This is a Roman courtyard fortress of the *castellum* type, 58X60 m in size, with a square courtyard and casement rooms around it. The space between the parallel walls is 5.5 m; they are well built of large, hewn stones. Three built entrances, 5 m wide each, were discerned: in

the eastern, western and southern sides.

The fortress was not completed, but abandoned in the middle of the construction. Each side was abandoned in a different building stage, and the southwest corner was not built at all. Inside, three piles of building stones were found. The



505. The fortress plan of 'Iraq Abu Hashish (A). The fortress was abandoned before its construction was completed.

eastern wall of the fortress is three courses high, and the others one or two.

In the wadi to the north of the fortress (Israel grid: 2008 1847) a well-built dam was found, made of small stones and plastered with mortar. It is 1 m wide and encloses a sort of a reservoir, which apparently served as the water source for the site. Next to the dam, in a wadi to the south, two built threshing floors were found.

Pottery: Very few shards were found, but the site was dated, most probably, by its shape to the Late Roman Period (2nd Century C.E.).

Identification: This is probably *Coabis*, a road station between Jericho and Beth Shean on the Peutinger Map; see chapter on identifications.

Bibliography: Zertal 1991, 6-18; Hashman 1996.

Previous surveys: none.



506. Aerial photo of the abandoned fortress of 'Iraq Abu Hashish (A)



507. The dam of the fortress of 'Iraq Abu Hashish (A), looking north. The figure stands on the remains of the wall. Similar dams typify the Roman military system in the region.



Site 249: 20 – 18/14/2

'Iraq Abu Hashish (B)

Israel grid: 2011 1841

UTM grid: 7393 7511

Elevation: 35 m b.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 1 km distant

Visibility: 4

May 25, 1990; 39 shards

A small site on the hilltop of 'Iraq Abu Hashish, 0.2 km south of the Roman fortress of the same name.

A small and elliptical courtyard,

20x25 m in size, is at the site, with sparse remains of structures around it. The walls are built of pebbles. The plan of the structures is indistinct; to the south are many piles

of stones, possibly concealing additional structures. To the west of the site, on a saddle 0.2 km away, are remnants of Bedouin encampment

and threshing floors.

Pottery: IrA II – 20%; LR – 20%; Byz – 30%; MA – 30%.

Previous surveys: none.



508. The small site of 'Iraq Abu Hashish (B), looking east. The figure is in the center of the site.



Site 250: 19 – 18/94/3

Muntar Mufyeh

Israel grid: 1991 1841

UTM grid: 7369 5710

Elevation: 189 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: small structure and fortress

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-Hilu (C23), 3.5 km distant

Visibility: 8

Mar. 13, 1982; Feb. 23, 1990; 51 shards

A site on a high hilltop in the Mufyeh Range, with a broad saddle extends between the site and Kh. Mufyeh (Site no. 251 here). North of the site is the new road to Hemdat.

In the north of the site there is a tower, 9x10 m in size and 2 m high, built of large stones whose dimensions are 0.6x0.6x0.8 m. The well built tower which contains two rooms is connected to a rectangular courtyard 25X20 m in size, surrounded by rooms on three of its sides. The three rooms in the west are 4.5x6 m, 4x4 m and 3.5x7 m. The two rooms on the south are

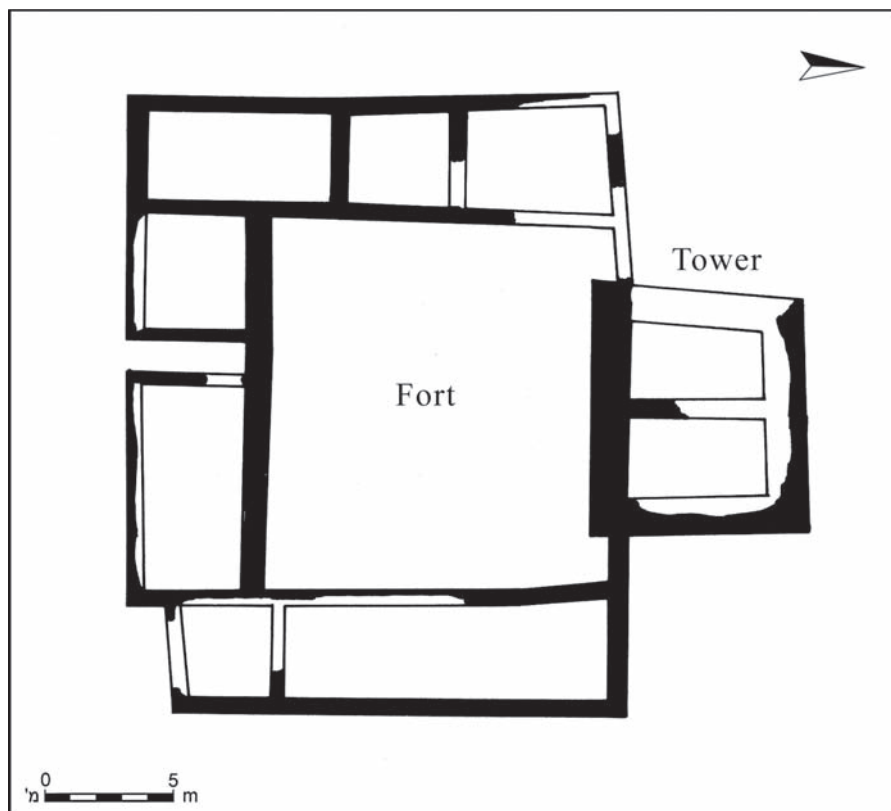
4x4.5 m and 4x8 m, with a possible entrance between them; On the east there is only one long hall. The outer walls are about 0.6 m wide, while the inner ones are 1 m wide.

Pottery: Hel (?) – 20%; ER – 20%; LR – 40%; Byz – 20%.

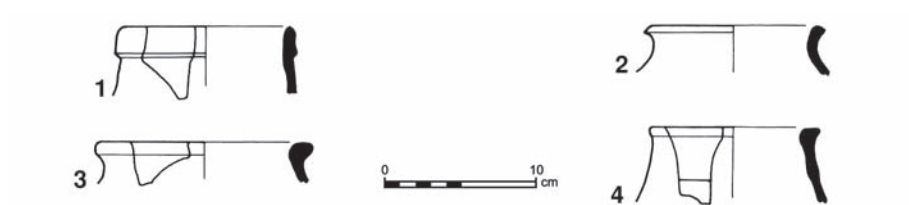
The site seems to be a watch-tower over the agricultural areas of Kh. Mufyeh. Both the SWP and the IES (Israeli Emergency Survey) defines it as such.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 153.

Bibliography: SWP II, 239.



509. Plan of the fortress at Muntar Mufyeh.



510. LR pottery from Muntar Mufyeh: 1, 4. Jars, lt br; 2-3. Jugs ,lt br.



511. Remnants of the small fortress of Muntar Mufyeh.

Site 251: 19 – 18/83/1

Khirbet Mufyeh (on SWP map: Kh. Mofia)

Israel grid: 1986 1836

UTM grid: 7376 5707

Elevation: 200 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: historical site on map

Site type: small town

Area: 20 dunams (5 acres)

Topography: valley edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 19

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-
Hilu (C23), 4 km distant

Visibility: 5

Mar. 13, 1982; Mar. 10, 1990; Feb.
20, 1993; 115 shards

* * *

A large ruin on a hilltop in east Manasseh, northeast of the Buqei'ah. It is located 3 km south of Kh. es-Samrah and 1.5 km

southwest of Hemdat. Steep slopes descends from the hilltop toward the Jordan Valley.

The complete terracing of the



512. The large site of Kh. Mufyeh from a bird's view, looking southeast. Most of the visible remains are Medieval, built on top of the early structures from the Roman and Byzantine Periods.

site's slopes created artificial levels used for building and cultivation.

The two distinct architectural stages in the site are as follows:

1. In the upper part of the hilltop is the later settlement, about 150 m in diameter. It contains six or seven building-complexes, with squares, lanes, passages, dwelling places and

inner courtyards. In most of the latter are cistern openings. The sloppily constructed inner walls are 0.6 m wide, without plaster or mortar, while the outer ones are 1.2 m wide. The stones must have been taken from the early structures.

2. Below the later settlement there is an earlier one, with well-



513. Overall plan of the small town at Kh. Mufyeh. The black lines indicate the earlier stage of the site, while the gray ones show the later stage. Note the courtyards and cisterns.

built, straight walls of large stones. Its plans were rendered unclear by the later building.

Presumably, the earlier stage can be dated to the Late Roman and Byzantine Periods, and the later stage to the Middle Ages (Mameluk Period) or perhaps slightly earlier.

Pottery: LR – 10%; Byz – 40%; EM

– 20%; MA (Mameluk) – 30%.

Coin find: 22 coins from the Late Roman, Byzantine and Early Moslem (Ummayyad) Periods; see appendix.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 153.

Bibliography: SWP II, 239.



514. The hilltop of Kh. Mufyeh with its buildings, looking northwest. The dark stains on the slope indicates soil out of cisterns.

Site 252: 19 – 18/83/2

Wadi Mufyeh

Israel grid: 1989 1831

UTM grid: 7373 5703

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: flat hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest

soil; quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Wadi el-Far'ah – Tel el-
Hilu (C23), 4.5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Mar. 15, 1990; 39 shards

* * *

A small site on a ridge descending north from the el-Asbah Range into Wadi Mufyeh, 0.4 km southeast of Kh. Mufyeh.

A few poorly-built walls and a medium-sized shard scatter are on

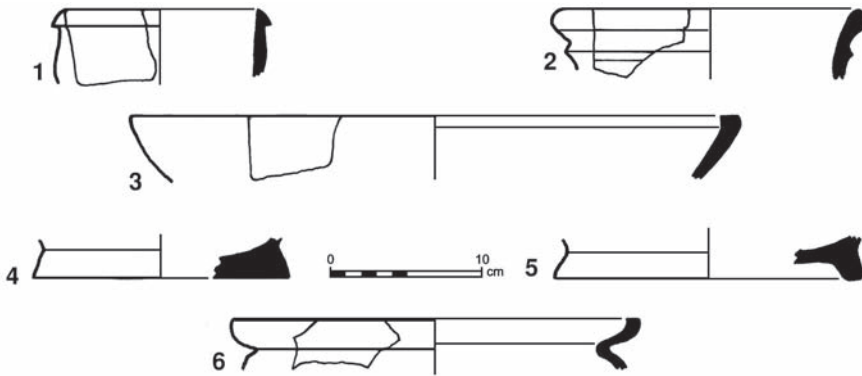
the site. These apparently belonged to several structures, perhaps seasonal ones.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 37%; IrA II – 40%; Byz – 23%.

Previous surveys: none.



515. Remains of a structure at the small site of Wadi Mufyeh, looking west. In the background is the hill of Kh. Mufyeh. 1990.



516. Pottery from Wadi Mufyeh: 1. Bowl, br, IrA II; 2. Jar, Pnk, MBA II; 3. Bowl, br, MBA II; 4. Bowl base, br, MBA II; 5. Jar base, IrA; 6. Bowl, pnk, MBA II.



Site 253: 19 – 18/82/1

Wadi Abu el-Loz

Israel grid: 1981 1820

UTM grid: 7373 5692

Elevation: 155 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site and enclosures

Area: 3 dunams (0.75 acre)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: rendzina; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman
(C21), 1.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Apr. 23, 1992; 44 shards and 39 flint
items

* * *

A site on a saddle in the Zahret el-Meidan ridge, near Wadi Abu el-Loz, with a good view of the Buqei'ah and the Jordan Valley.

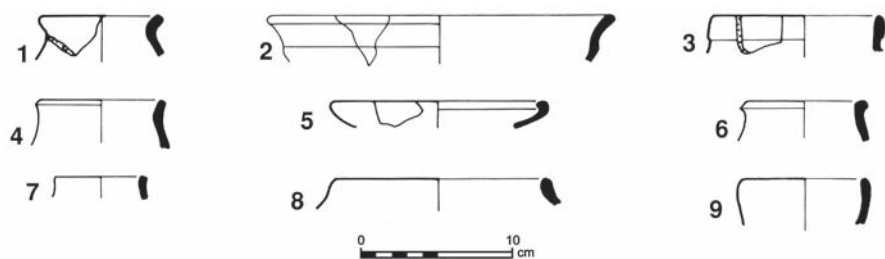
On the site are two connected irregular-shaped enclosures, each measures 30x35 m. The walls are built of one row of large stones. Between the enclosures there is a long and narrow structure, 2x14 m in size. Inside the enclosures there are several walls.

The site was probably built during Middle Bronze Age IIB-C, and was in secondary use during the Byzantine Period. Many flint items are scattered around.

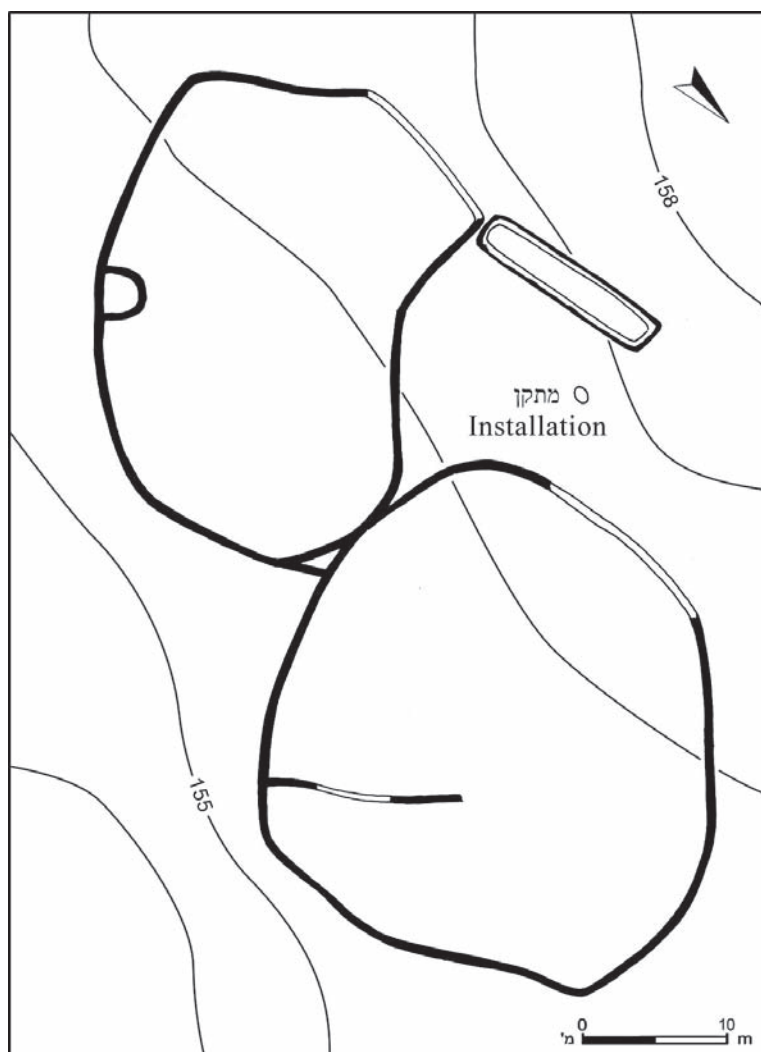
Pottery: MBA IIB – 60%; LR – 5%; Byz – 35%.

Flint find: Epipalaeolithic and Natufian, see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



517. Pottery from Wadi Abu el-Loz. nos. 2, 5, 8 – MBA II; the rest – LR and Byz: 1, 3-4. Jars, br; 2, 5. Bowls, lt; 6-7. Small jugs, lt br; 8. Folded CP, br; 9. Small bowl, lt.



518. Plan of the Middle Bronze Age enclosures of Wadi Abu el-Loz.



519. The saddle with the site of Wadi Abu el-Loz, located between the jeep and the figure at right, looking east.



Site 254: 19 – 18/81/1

Zahret el-Meidan (A)

Israel grid: 1987 1819

UTM grid: 7370 7688

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman (C21), 2 km distant

Visibility: 5

Jun. 15, 1990; 60 shards and 14 flint items

* * *

A structure on a saddle, surrounded by deep wadis of the Zahret el-Meidan Range. It is located north

of the Buqei'ah and about 2 km south-southwest of Hemdat.

The trapezoidal structure, built

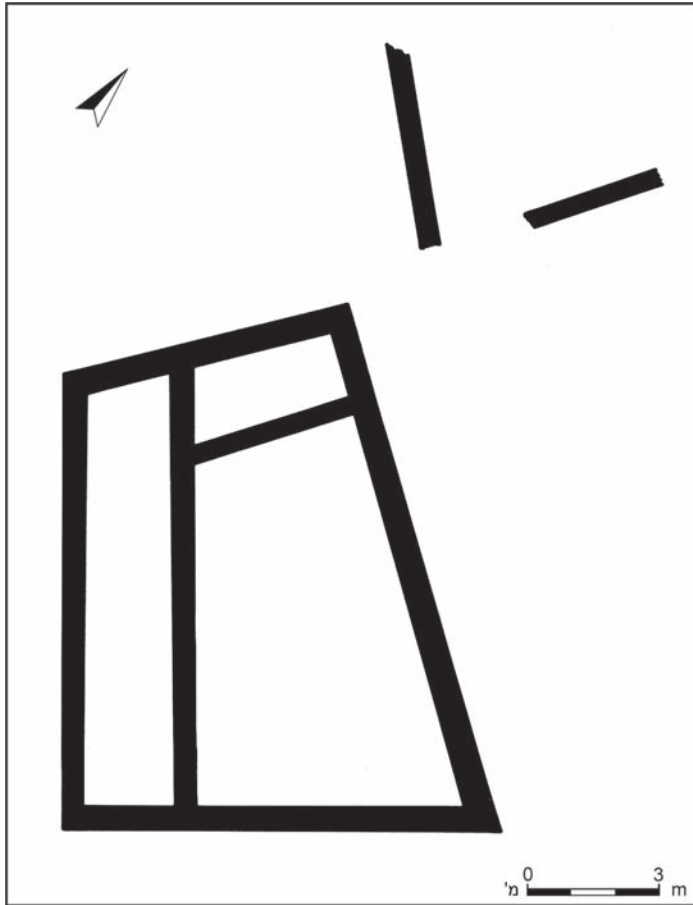
of large stones, measures 12x20 m. Inside it are two parallel long spaces, one wide and the other narrow, with a small room in the end. A wall protrudes from near the northern corner to another possible structure.

Northeast of the site is a terraced ravine.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 90%; IrA II – 10%.

Flint find: Unidentified; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



520. The Middle Bronze Age II structure at Zahret el-Meidan (A), one of the few of its type in the array of settlements of this period.



521. General view, looking west, of the structure at Zahret el-Meidan (A). The site is located in the center of the saddle. The deep wadi in the background is Wadi Abu el-Loz, and the high range is E.P. 273.



Site 255: 20 – 18/11/1

Khirbet Wadi el-Gharur (A)

Israel grid: 2018 1811

UTM grid: 7411 5682

Elevation: 240 m b.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: caves and small site

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: slope near a narrow valley

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 8

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), passes by site

Visibility: 5

Jan. 20, 1989; 41 shards

A small site on the northern bank of Wadi el-Gharur, next to the outlet of the wadi to the Jordan Valley.

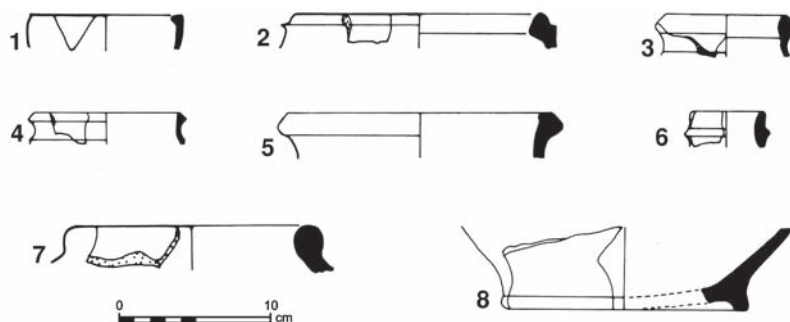
The ruin is situated on a moderate slope descending south to Wadi el-Gharur. Its northern part is next

to a row low cliffs, in which two large, natural caves were found. In front of these few structural remains, walls *in situ* and a large shard scatter are discerned. Apparently the site extended into the caves and

over the slope.

Pottery: IrA II – 20%; ER – 20%; LR – 10%; Byz – 40%; MA – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



522. Pottery from Khirbet Wadi el-Gharur (A): 2-3, 5, 7-8 – IrA II: 1. Small bowl, ER; 2. CP, dk br; 3. Jar, br; 4. Jar, lt br, ER; 5. Crater, br; 6. Juglet, lt br, LR; 7-8. Craters, dk br.



523. View to the east of the site of Kh. Wadi el-Gharur (A). At left are the cliffs containing the caves, part of the site.

Site 256: 19 – 18/90/1

Zahret el-Meidan (B)

Israel grid: 1992 1805

UTM grid: 7376 5675

Elevation: 155 m a.s.l., 120 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: stone circles

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 8 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman
(C21), 2 km distant

Visibility: 7

Jun. 15, 1990; 28 shards

* * *

A site on a plateau northeast of the Buqei'ah, about 3 km south of Hemdat, with a fine view of the Buqei'ah and the Jordan Valley. A dirt road from Kh. Mufyeh to the Jordan Valley passes nearby.

At the site are two round, stones-built circles, one inside the other. The outer one is 35 m in diameter, with a surrounding wall built of two rows of large stones and one m wide. In the center of the outer



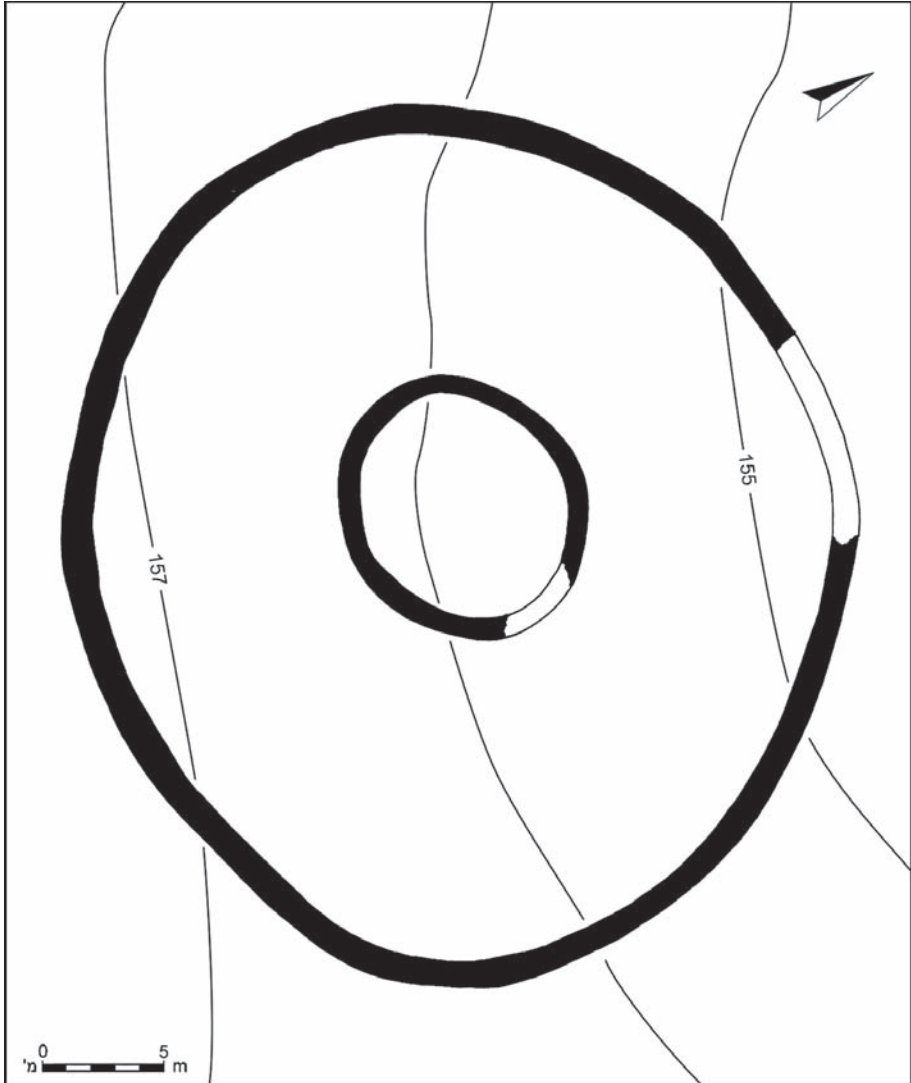
524. Bird's eye view of the stone circles at Zahret el-Meidan (B). The function of these well-built circles, apparently constructed during Middle Bronze Age II, is unknown.

circle is a smaller one, about 10 m in diameter, with disturbances from some later time. Between the two circles are remains of a small wall. The construction is regular and well done.

This extraordinary site can be explained by various directions, yet it surely was not a dwelling place.

Pottery: MBA IIB – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



525. Plan of the stone circles from Middle Bronze Age II at Zahret el-Meidan (B).

Site 257: 20 – 18/10/1

Khirbet Wadi el-Gharur (B)

Israel grid: 2018 1809

UTM grid: 5680 7409

Elevation: 230 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: shard scatter

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: wadibed

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: alluvium; quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 1.5 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 3

Jan. 20, 1989; 39 shards

* * *

A small site in the valley of Wadi el-Gharur, about 0.3 km southwest of Kh. Wadi el-Gharur (A).

In a cultivated field, next to a line of cleared stones, concentrations of

shards were found. Apparently a house or two stood there for a short period.

Pottery: IrA II – 100%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 258: 20 – 18/10/2

Sheikh Gharur

Israel grid: 2019 1807

UTM grid: 5678 7411

Elevation: 250 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small site

Area: 0.6 dunam (0.15 acre)

Topography: valley and valley edge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest
soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 6

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Jan. 20, 1989; 53 shards

* * *

A small site next to the Jordan Valley road and south of Wadi Gharur, about 6 km north-northeast of Ar-gaman.

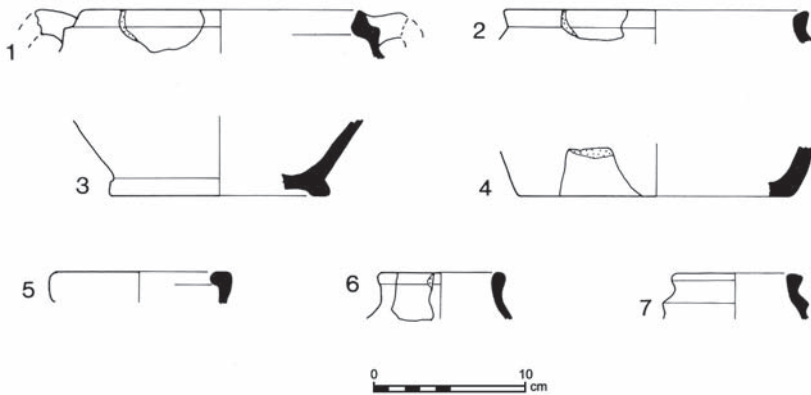
A shard scatter was found in a

plowed field, next to piles of cleared stones. Cultivation has destroyed the structures (only one wall remains *in situ*) and scattered the shards, but it can be assumed that

there was a single structure or farm – 70%.
at the site.

Previous surveys: none.

Pottery: EBA II – 30%; IrA II



526. Pottery from Sheikh Gharur, from EBA (nos. 2, 4) and IrA II (the rest): 1. CP D, br; 2. Bowl, lt; 3. Crater base, br; 4. Jar base, rough, lt; 5. Small bowl, yel; 6-7. Jars, lt br.



Site 259: 20 – 17/19/1

Khirbet el-Gharur (on SWP map: Kh. Karur)

Israel grid: 2014 1798

UTM grid: 7398 5669

Elevation: 155 m b.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: historic site on map

Site type: permanent military camp

Area: 9 dunams (2.25 acres)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 6

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 0.8 km distant

Visibility: 7

Jan. 20, 1989; Apr. 22, 1993; 108 shards

A permanent Roman military camp on a high, flat hilltop overlooking the Jordan Valley, about 4 km north-northeast of Argaman and 0.8 km west of the Jordan Valley Road.

The site is trapezoid in shape; its dimensions are 116 m (south side), 104 m (north side), 72 m (east side) and 56 m (west side). It is surrounded by a wall 1.5 m wide, built of medium-sized stones. This

wall is well preserved in the east and south, but the remaining sides have been heavily damaged by Israeli Defense Forces activity. These activities have also damaged other parts of the site, most of which are restorable for the plan. The inner space is full by square blocks of rooms connected by streets, thus the site is apparently a combination of two Roman military types: *castellum* (courtyard fortress) and a *castrum* (permanent camp).

The place is divided into quarters by means of streets 2.5–4 m wide in average. Two north-south streets were found in the eastern half of the site, with three east-west streets survived as well. In the quarters many densely built structures are discerned, built of large, hewn stones; their collapse cover the site

now with a layer of fallen stones. In the quarters there are blocks of square rooms, averaging 4x4 m in size; the entrances are through well-smoothen stone doorposts *in situ* with bolt holes. Between the blocks are at least two inner squares 12.5x12.5 m in size, with a large cistern in the middle of each. More cisterns were found in other places, inside and outside of the camp.

Slightly to the west of the camp's center is the main tower, about 10x10 m in size. It is built of very large stones with hewn edges, and rises 2-3 m above the present level of fallen stones.

Next to the southwest corner of the site, on the outside, an additional architectural unit is discerned, 22.5x30 m in size (0.7 dunams,



527. View to the east of the Roman camp from 2nd-3rd Century C.E. at Kh. el-Gharur. The piles of stones indicate the structures, following destruction by the IDF.

or 0.18 acre in area). Here there is a large courtyard and several rectangular rooms attached to it from

the inside, with another cistern. A similar courtyard and rectangular rooms were found in the southwest

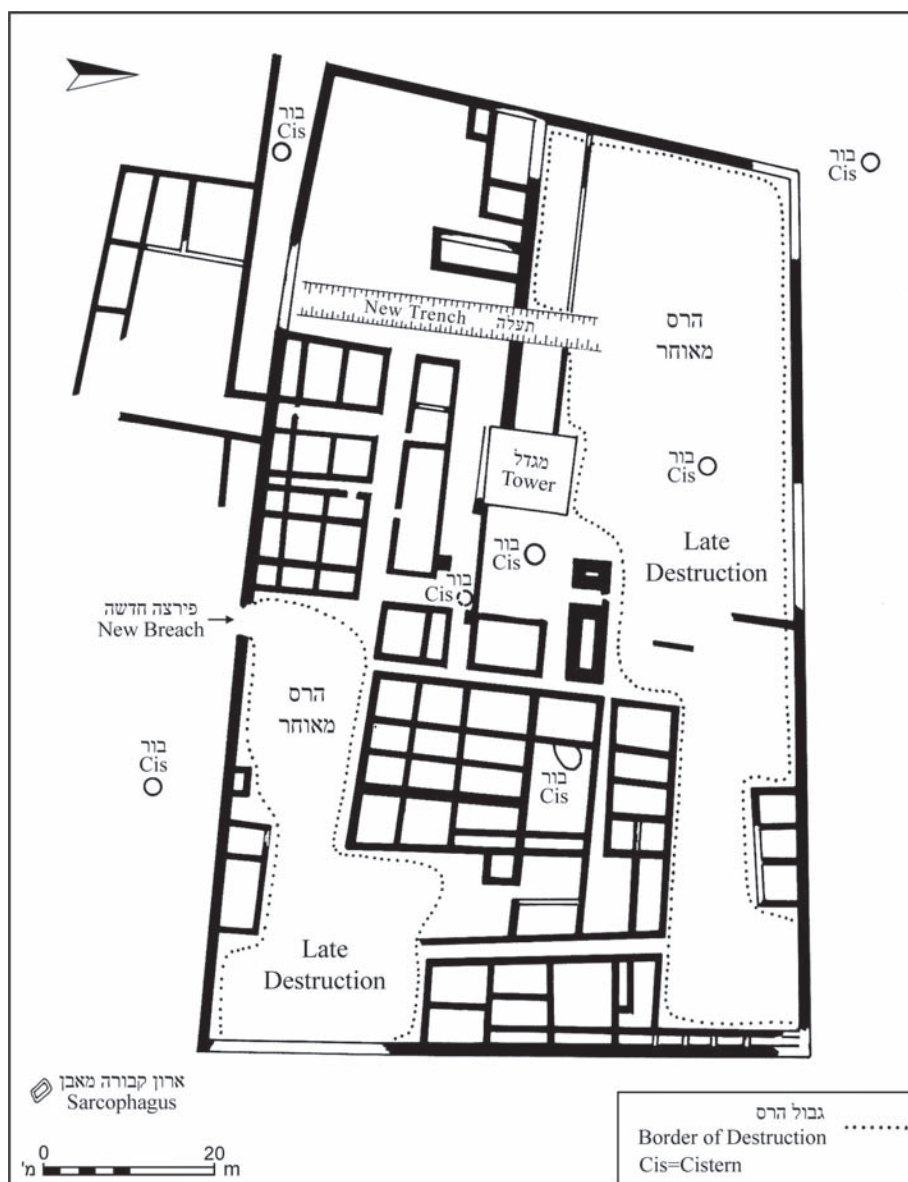


528. The Roman camp of Kh. el-Gharur, a bird's eye view, looking west. The shape of the site and the destruction by the IDF can be seen well. The dam of the site is in the upper, right side of the photo.

part of the camp on the inside.

A 1-m long stone, with a carved line dividing it, is found in the rubble. In one half there is an X and an O in the other.

The camp is precisely and well built. In some of the sections made by the army tractors, a thick layer of ash was discernible, offering a possible clue as to the fate of the site.



529. Plan of the camp of Kh. el-Gharur. Note the basic similarity to Kh. es-Suweideh.

On the outside of the southeast corner of the camp, a stone *sarcophagus*, broken and covered with soot, was found. It had clearly been heated and broken apart, perhaps in order to find treasure inside.

Some 0.3 km west of the site, in a small wadi that leads into Wadi el-Gharur, a dam, 15 m long and 2 m wide, is discerned. It is built of small stones strengthened by cement mixed with pottery fragments.

Pottery: LR (2nd-3rd Century C.E.) – 100%.

Special find: Three coins from the 3rd Century C.E. (see appendix) and a handle of a bronze jug.

This permanent Roman camp is designed according to the standard plan of such sites. It was a part of the military array along the Jordan Valley, including also Kh. Khiraf (site no. 266 here), 'Iraq Abu Hashish (site no. 248 here) and Kh. es-Suweideh (site no. 239 here). The site was established and existed in the 2nd-3rd Century C.E., as evidenced by the pottery and coins. The absence of later shards indicates a short life-span.

To the above the fortresses of Kh. Humsah (site no. 143 here) and Kh. Umm Kharaz (site no. 144 here) should probably be added.

In 1990 and 1991 Hirschfeld published an incomplete plan of



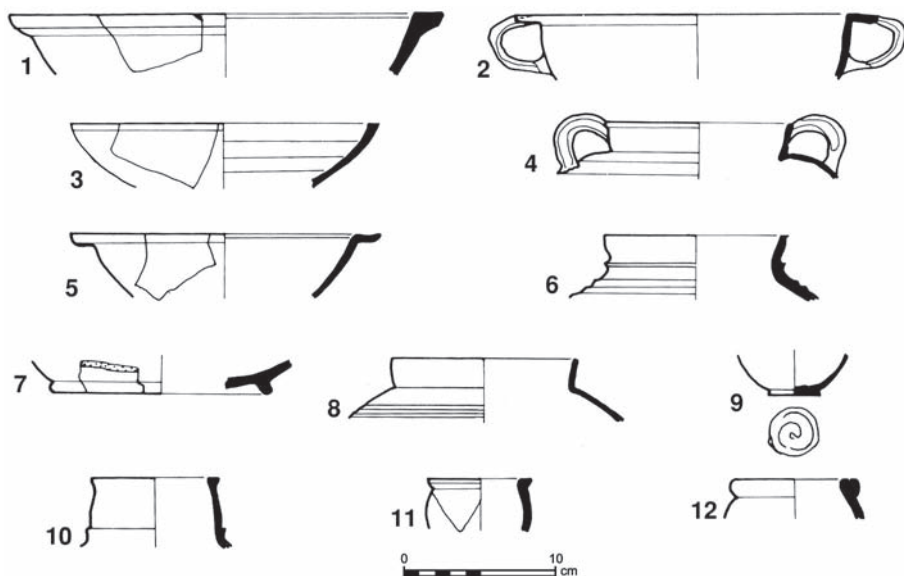
530. View of the built dam in Wadi Gharur, near and west of the camp. The Roman military array is typified by dams built in the proximity of the camps for water supply.

the site and proposed that it was a “fortified village from the Roman Period”.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Po-

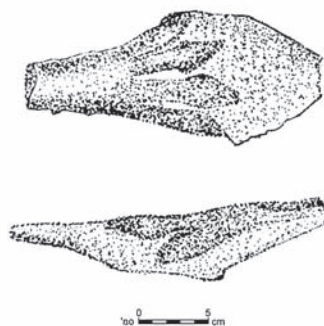
rath 1972, no. 169.

Bibliography: SWP II, 238; Hirschfeld 1990, 45-46; 1991; Hashman 1996.



531. Pottery from the site, all from LR (2nd-3rd C.E.): 1-3. Bowls, lt br; 4. CP, dk br; 5. Bowl, br; 6, 8. Jars, lt br; 7. Bowl base, lt br; 9. Jug base, br; 10-12. Jars and jugs, br.

532. Two sides of a bronze handle from Kh. el-Gharur, designed as a bird's foot. This is identical in design to the vase-handles found in the caves of Bar Kochba in the Judean desert by Yadin (1963, fig 20: 10-11 and pp. 72-73), who suggested that their origin is from Roman camps.





533. A carved stone from Kh. Gharur.



Site 260: 19 – 17/88/2

el-Munsahleh

Israel grid: 1985 1785

UTM grid: 7378 7656

Elevation: 10 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: structure

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Colluvial-Alluvial;

quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 6 km distant

Nearest road: Buqei'ah – Argaman
Junction (C21), passes by site

Visibility: 3

May 8, 1983; 32 shards

A site on a ridge in the southeast part of the Buqei'ah, slightly north-east of Kh. Umm Kharaz.

Here there is a small structure, 6x6 m in size. It is built of field

stones, with an entrance on the north side, but contains no internal division. North of the structure is a flat area with various stone walls and a shard scatter.

Pottery: IrA III – 50%; Byz – *Previous surveys:* none.
50%.



Site 261: 19 – 17/97/1

Ras en-Naqb Baqar

Israel grid: 1998 1779
UTM grid: 7380 7650
Elevation: 40 m a.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.
Name type: nearest place
Site type: circles of stone
Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
Topography: high summit
Rock type: 'Avdat formation
Soil type: Colluvial-Alluvial;
quality: 2

Cultivation: none
Cisterns: none
Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 3.5 km distant
Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), 2 km distant
Visibility: 3
May 8, 1983; 20 shards and 20 flint
items

* * *

A stone-circles site on the summit
of Ras en-Naqb Baqar, a tall moun-
tain 2 km north of Argaman.

Two circles of large stones are
discerned, each 25 m in diameter.
Nearby there is a small shard and

flint scatter.

Pottery: EBA – 100%.

Flint find: Middle Paleolithic; see
appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 262: 20 – 17/06/5

Wadi Abu Sidreh

Israel grid: 2002 1769
UTM grid: 7386 5641
Elevation: 230 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.
Name type: nearest place
Site type: small site
Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
Topography: broad wadi
Rock type: 'Avdat formation
Soil type: colluvial-alluvial; quality: 4

Cultivation: none
Cisterns: none
Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 3 km distant
Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), 1.5 km distant
Visibility: 1
Feb. 17, 1989; 41 shards

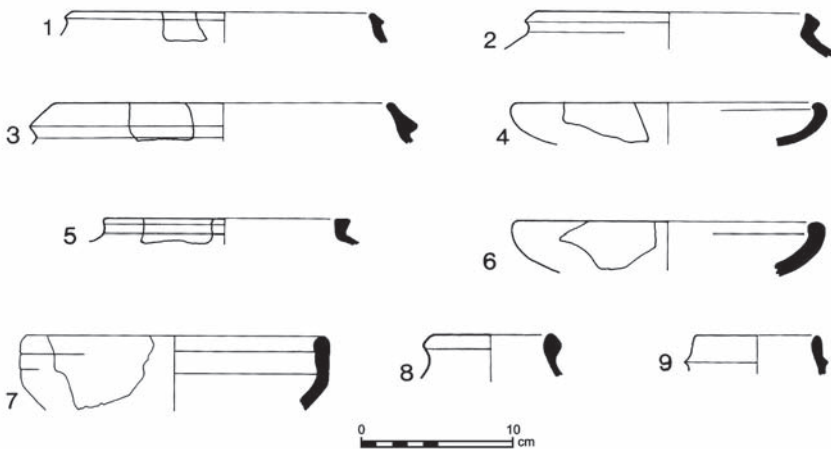
A small site on a step created by sediment, east of the channel of Wadi Abu Sidreh and 1 km north

of Argaman.

The step is composed of huwwar, in the edge of which are remains of



534. The site of Wadi Abu Sidreh, looking west from the wadi.



535. Pottery from the site of Wadi Abu Sidreh: nos. 1-2. CP type A, dk br, IrA IA; 3. CP type B, IrA I; 4, 6. 'Manassite' bowls, lt br, IrA IA; 5. Bowl, br, Byz; 7. Bowl, gray, IrA II; 8-9. Jars, br, IrA II.

a wall built of large stones, possibly built for protection against erosion. On the northern part of the step there are the remains of several rectangular-shaped buildings with walls built of local stone. A large shard scatter is near and around the site.

Many *Sysyphus* trees, typical to the area, grow next to the site and in the wadi. The site may have served as a farm and an encampment of nomads.

Pottery: IrA IA – 30%; IrA II – 30%; Byz – 20%; MA – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 263: 19 – 17/76/2

Mugharet Umm Khubezah

Israel grid: 1979 1766

UTM grid: 7562 5656

Elevation: 50 m b.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: cave dwelling

Area: 0.5 dunam (0.13 acre)

Topography: slope and wadi rock

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 5 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 4 km distant

Visibility: 1

Jan. 1, 1993; 40 shards

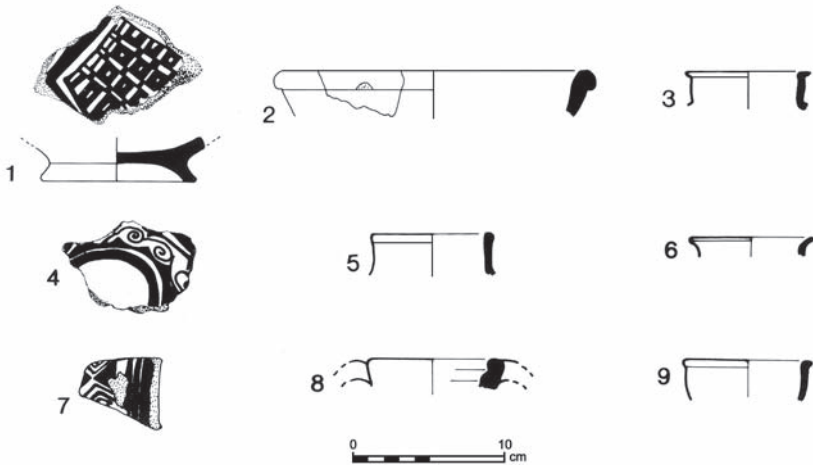
A large cave dwelling on the western bank of Wadi Umm Khubezah, in a steep, mountainous area, 1.5 km west of Argaman. The dirt road from Argaman to the Buqei'ah passes close by, to the south to the cave.

The cave contains a large entrance 20 m in diameter. Beyond it is a wide rock pillar with stone passages on both sides, and another

large, inner hall. The ceiling of the latter has collapsed; its walls contain niches and depressions. On the floor are thick layers of sheep and goat manure, shards and other material. Most of the shards were collected on the slope in front of the cave.

Pottery: Byz – 20%; EM – 5%; MA – 50%; Ott – 15%; Mod – 10%.

Previous surveys: none.



536. Pottery from Mugharet Umm Khubezah: nos. 1, 4, 7 – MA; the rest – Byz: 1. Bowl base, dec, br on white; 2. Bowl, br; 3. Jar, lt br; 4,7. Dec shards, br on white; 6. Jug, gray; 8-9. Jars, dk gray.



Site 264: 19 – 17/76/3

Wadi Ras Umm Khubezah

Israel grid: 1978 1764

UTM grid: 5635 7361

Elevation: 40 m b.s.l., l.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and encampment

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: Mediterranean brown forest soil and mountainous rendzina;

quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 4 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 5 km distant

Visibility: 2

Jan. 1, 1993; 63 shards and 30 flint items

* * *

A small encampment on a saddle in a mountainous area, close to the beginning of Wadi Umm Khubezah. Wadi and the road from Argaman to the Buqei'ah.

Two construction stages were discerned:

1. An early stage of two round enclosures, southern and northern, built of large stones. Only part of them was preserved.

2. On top of these, simple construction is discerned, with walls built of small stones and tent bases

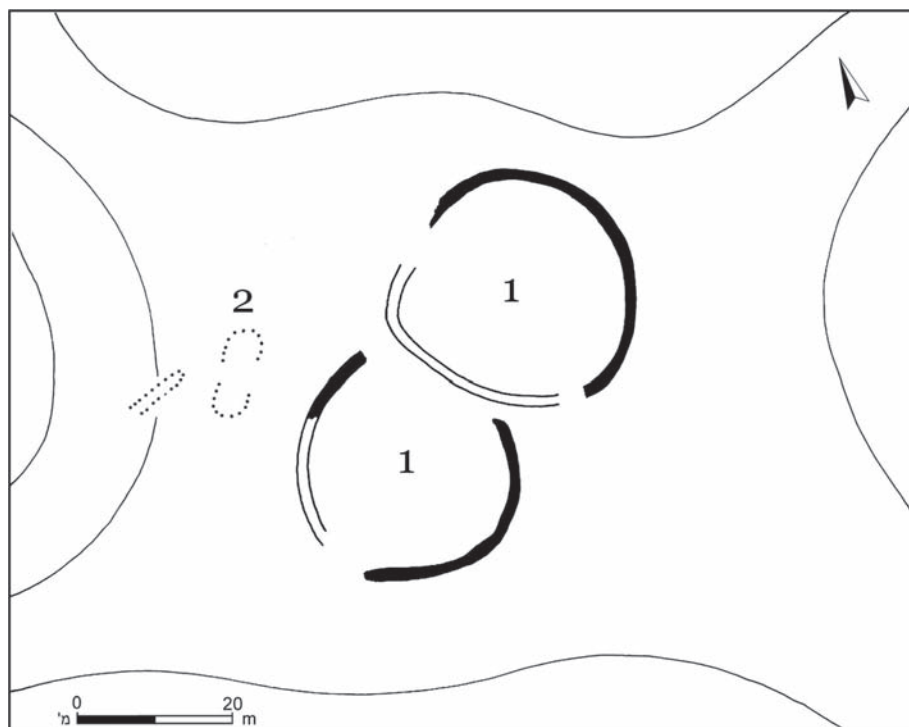
and installations. In the second part of the site, to the south and west of the road, remains of encampments and a shard scatter are discerned on a broad saddle and on several ridges. In this area, a fragment of an Iron Age IA cooking pot (Type A) and shards from Iron Age II were

collected.

Pottery: IrA I – (?); IrA II – 28%; Byz – 40%; MA – 14%; Ott – 6%; Mod – 12%.

Flint find: unidentified items; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



537. Plan of the enclosures of the encampment site on the saddle near Wadi Ras Umm Khubezah.

Site 265: 20 – 17/06/2

‘Iraq Matar

Israel grid: 2002 1765

UTM grid: 7387 5636

Elevation: 205 m b.s.l., 40 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: ‘Avdat formation

Soil type: stony-desert soil;

quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River
(no. 112), 2 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-
meh (B10), 1 km distant

Visibility: 3

Nov. 24, 1989; 71 shards

* * *

An enclosure and structures in the Khiraf Range, about 1 km north of Argaman.

The enclosure, built of large stones and 46 m diameter (maximum), is close to a low cliff to the

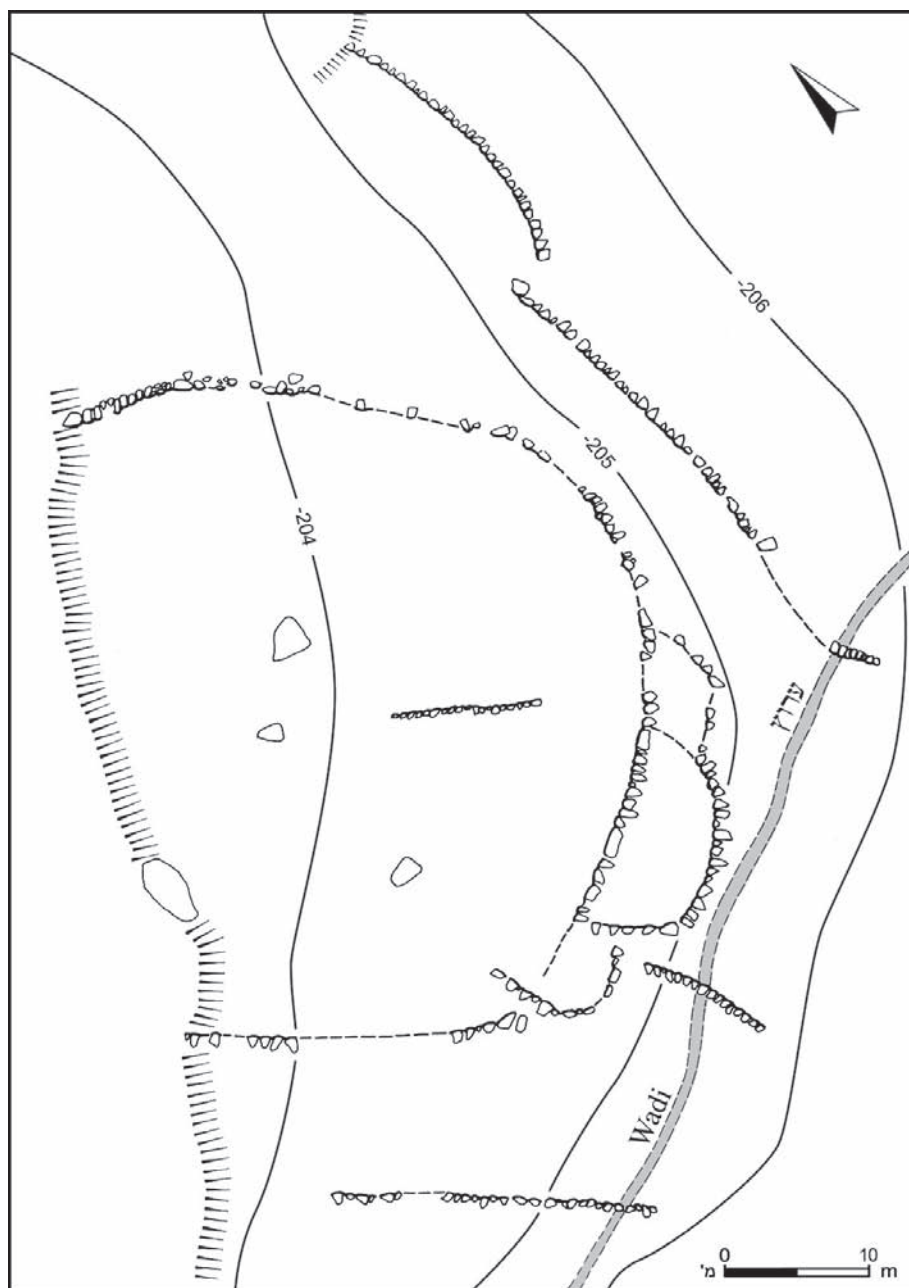
west, from which the semicircle starts. The built side of the enclosure-wall is its inner side. In the south, at least three small spaces (dwelling units?) are adjacent to the enclosure wall from the outside



538. A view to the northwest of the round enclosure from the beginning of Iron Age I at ‘Iraq Matar.

south. Outside of the enclosure is a partially-preserved parallel wall of unknown function. Inside the en-

closure is a short wall ending with an upright *monolith*, and another *monolith* stands nearby. A number



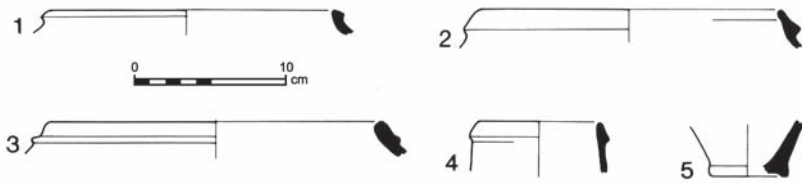
539. Plan of 'Iraq Matar, next to the Jordan Valley.

of walls (dams?) cross the nearby wadi.

Pottery: IrA IA – 80%; Byz – 20%.

Previous surveys: none.

In 1999 a certain person published in the PEQ a copy of our Hebrew site, without mentioning the origin.



540. Pottery from the site: 1-3. CP A and B, dk br, IrA IA; 4. Jar, Byz; 5. Jug base, dk br, IrA I.



Site 266: 20 – 17/06/1

Khirbet Khiraf

Israel grid: 2001 1762

UTM grid: 7384 5632

Elevation: 103 m b.s.l., 100 m a.s.a.

Name type: historic site on map

Site type: fortress

Area: 7 dunams (1.75 acres)

Topography: ridge edge and hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: stony-desert soil; quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Jordan River (no. 112), 2.5 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Ham-meh (B10), 0.5 km distant

Visibility: 8

Mar. 17-24, 1989; 84 shards

A fortress on a high and broad hilltop, east of E.P. 103 and above the big bend of Wadi Abu Sidreh. It is about 1 km north of Argaman, and provides a fine view of the central part of the Jordan Valley.

The fortress, which is connected in the west to a saddle, is located close to a steep cliff in the south. It is a trapezoidal-shaped structure with unequal sides: its dimensions

are 56 m (eastern, northern and western sides), while the south side is 66.5 m. The internal area of the fortress is 3.4 dunams (0.85 acre). The western and eastern walls continue on south, beyond the corners of the fortress, up to the edge of the cliff, and connect to it. In this way, an additional 2.4 dunams (0.6 acre) are added to the area of the fortress. Between the walls connecting the

fortress to the cliff another wall was built, which runs parallel to the south side of the fortress and is 12 m away from it. This wall created a long, narrow space whose purpose is unknown.

The fortress itself is an inner courtyard, surrounded by various types of rooms (6x6 m in dimensions), which are attached to the inside of the outer wall. This wall, built of large local (hard Eocene limestone and local conglomerate), is 1.2 m wide. The roughly hewn stones, mostly fallen now close to the wall, are 0.4x0.5x0.6 m on the average. The level of the collapse indicates a single story structures, except for the towers in the corners.

The towers in the four corners are not protruding from the surrounding-wall. Their dimensions are 5x5 m (outside), with a level of fallen stones higher than that of the other walls. Another tower is in the center of the northern side, next to one of the two presumed entrances. This tower, containing two units (rooms or halls), whose dimensions are 5x7 m, apparently protected the northern entrance. Another possible entrance was in the east side, close to the tower in the southeast corner. A new opening was made on the west side by the IDF.

In several places, a second series of rooms was built inside the courtyard, close to and parallel to the



541. Remains of the fortress at Kh. Khiraf, viewed to the east. In the background are the valley and white huwwar hills of the *zor* and the *ghor*.

first series. Such double series were found next to the southwest corner, in the eastern part of the southern wall and all along the eastern wall. The area between the northern and the northeastern towers, 240 sq. m. in area, seems to be of special importance. It contains long halls and adjacent courtyards. Near the northwestern tower an extension of nine rooms enters the inner yard.

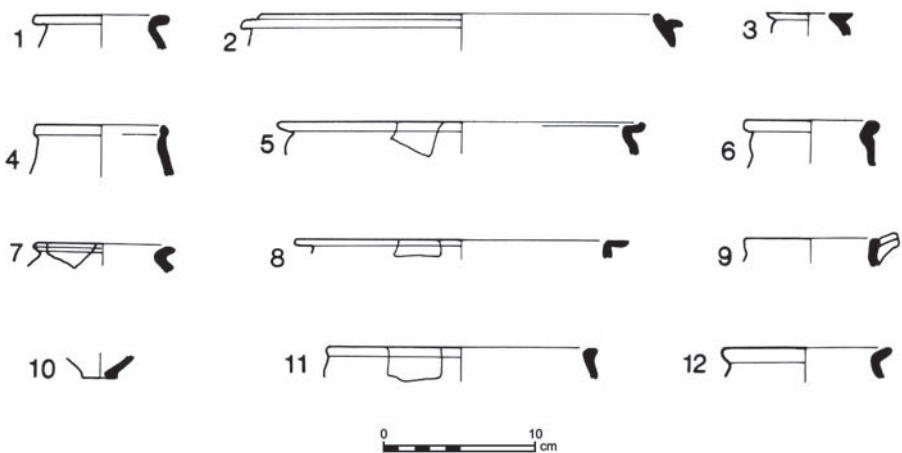
At least 72 architectural units

(rooms or courtyards) were located throughout the fortress, with an overall built-up area of about 1.9 dunams (0.48 acre). A prudent calculation indicates 100-150 permanent inhabitants here.

Following our publication it was published also by Hirschfeld (1991), with a partial plan and chronological conclusions similar to ours.



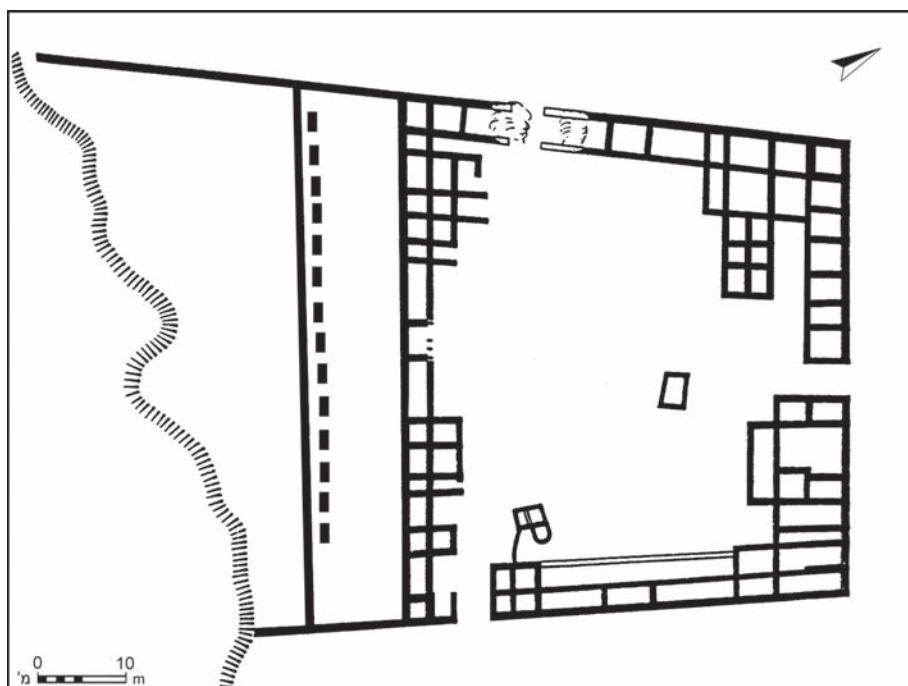
542. A bronze coin of Hadrian, minted in Caesarea, from Kh. Khiraf.



543. Pottery from the fortress at Kh. Khiraf, all from LR – Byz: in the central column – bowls; in side columns – jars and jugs.



544. Bird's eye view of the fortress at Kh. Khiraf, looking west.



545. Plan of the fortress, as measured by the Manasseh Hill Country staff.

Pottery: LR (2nd-3rd Century C.E.) – 100%.

Coins finds: one coin of Hadrian from Caesarea Maritima, see appendix.

Previous surveys: Gophna and Porath 1972, no. 227.

Bibliography: Zertal 1992, 3-8; Hirschfeld 1991; Hashman 1996.



Site 267: 19 – 17/75/1

Ras el-Kharubeh

Israel grid: 1972 1752

UTM grid: 7358 5622

Elevation: 130 b.s.l., 10 m b.s.a

Name type: nearest range

Site type: encampment

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

Topography: saddle

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: stony-desert soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 3 km distant

Nearest road: Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), 3 km distant

Visibility: 5

Feb. 4, 1994; 68 shards



546. Bedouin tents on the typical encampment site in the cliffs of Ras Kharubeh, looking west.

An encampment site on a broad saddle in the center of Umm Kharubeh Range, near a junction of dirt roads crossing the range.

On top of the saddle, remains of simple structures, built of small stones, are discerned. Each structure contained several rooms. The shard scatter is large and varied. This is one of the many encamp-

ment sites on the range.

Pottery: IrA I – 20%; IrA II – 6%; LR – 12%; Byz – 9%; MA – 13%; Ott – 3%; Mod – 22%; unidentified – 15%.

Previous surveys: none.

On the range of Ras el-Kharubeh, the following encampment sites were found:



267/1: 19 – 17/66/1

Israel grid: 1965 1762
UTM grid: 7349 5632
Elevation: 155 m a.s.l.

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)
62 shards and three flint items

An encampment site on a saddle, next to the road descending from the Ras el-Kharubeh Range into Mutaqallabat Valley.

A few tent bases made of small

stones and a medium-sized shard scatter were found at the site.

Pottery: IrA II – 27%; LR-Byz – 59%; MA – 8%; Mod – 6%.

Previous surveys: none.



267/2: 19 – 17/66/2

Israel grid: 1969 1769
UTM grid: 7355 5633
Elevation: 140 m a.s.l.

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)
47 shards and nine flint items

An encampment on a northeastern shoulder of Ras el-Kharubeh, about 0.3 km from EP 211. At the site there are few tent bases, arranged stones and a medium-sized shard

scatter.

Pottery: MBA II – 2%; IrA II – 36%; LR – 58%; Mod – 4%.

Previous surveys: none.

267/3: 19 – 17/65/1

Israel grid: 1961 1759
 UTM grid: 7348 5629
 Elevation: 40 m a.s.l.

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)
 65 shards and 60 flint items

* * *

An encampment on the northern bank of a wadi which descends westward from Ras el-Kharubeh. At the site are sections of buildings with poorly constructed walls, fallen

stones and circles of stones belonging to a relatively modern tents.

Pottery: IrA II – 23%; Ott – 50%; Mod – 27%.

Previous surveys: none.

**267/4: 19 – 17/55/1**

Israel grid: 1959 1758
 UTM grid: 7343 5628
 Elevation: 30 m a.s.l.

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
 64 shards

* * *

An encampment on a western side of Ras el-Kharubeh, next to a wadi. Seven circles of stone were found at the site, with small, paved areas. A

wall built of one row of small stones is on the west side.

Pottery: IrA II – 6%; Ott – 94%.

Previous surveys: none.

**267/5: 19 – 17/64/1**

Israel grid: 1969 1748
 UTM grid: 7358 5619
 Elevation: 100 m a.s.l.

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
 39 shards and 100 flint items

* * *

A site on a large saddle on the Ras el-Kharrubeh Range, next to EP 121. The site, divided by the dirt road of Ras el-Kharrubeh, consists of structure built of large stones, with several rooms. Nearby there are the remains of a contemporary Bedouin encampment with a large

tumulus at EP 121 and many flint items nearby.

Pottery: Chal – 50%; IrA II – 50%.

Flint find: Middle Paleolithic.

Previous surveys: none.



547. Plan of the central structure at site 267/5 on Ras Kharubeh.



267/6: 19 – 17/73/1

Israel grid: 1979 1736
UTM grid: 7361 5606
Elevation: 67 m b.s.l.

Area: 5 dunams (1.25 acres)
28 shards and four flint items

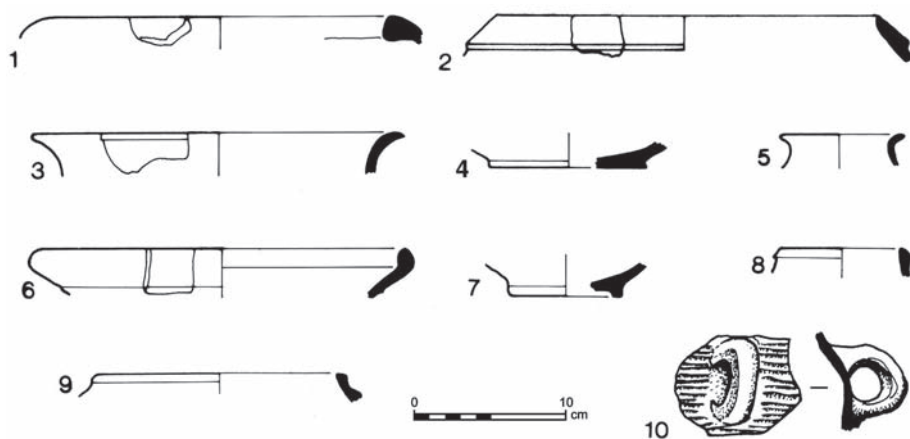
An encampment at the top of a wadi of Umm Kharrubeh Range.

On both sides of the wadi there are a few remains of walls, that provided support for the tents. There are also several built installations.

Next to the site, to the east and west, two built *tumuli* were found.

Pottery: MBA II – 21%; IrA I – 7%; Byz – 36%; MA – 14%; Mod – 22%.

Previous surveys: none.



548. Pottery from the Ras Kharrubeh site 267/6: nos. 1-2, 6 – IrA I; 3-4 – MBA; the rest – Byz and MA: 1. HM jar, br; 2. CP, br; 3. Bowl, lt, MBA II; 4. Bowl base, pk, MBA II; 5. Jug, gray, Byz; 6. 'Manassite' bowl, br; 7. Jug base, lt, MBA II; 8. Jar, br, Byz; 9. Bowl, br, Byz; 10. Jar handle, br, Byz.



267/7: 19 – 17/72/1

Israel grid: 1971 1728

UTM grid: 7358 5598

Elevation: 130 m b.s.l.

Area: 4 dunams (1 acre)

51 shards and 14 flint items

* * *

An encampment on a broad saddle, in the southwest part of the Ras el-Kharubeh Range, next to the Shechem – Jiftliq road.

The site, with few remains of stone walls and platforms, is located on two low hills and its architecture

has been disturbed by later activity. All over the site is a shard and flint scatter.

Pottery: IrA I – 25%; LR – 15%; Byz – 18%; MA – 6%; Ott – 12%; Mod – 24%.

Previous surveys: none.



549. The site of 267/7 on Ras Kharrubeh, looking west.



267/8: 19 – 17/72/2

Israel grid: 1975 1728
UTM grid: 7360 5609
Elevation: 70 m a.s.l.

Area: 1 dunam (0.25 acre)
36 shards and 14 flint items

* * *

An encampment site on a saddle in the southern part of the Ras el-Kharubeh Range. Steep wadis descend from the site eastward and westward; the road of Ras el-Kharubeh crosses the site.

There is a cleared area for tents here but no architectural finds, except for one small circle of stones.

Pottery: IrA II – 15%; Byz – 70%; Ott – 15%.

Previous surveys: none.

267/9: 19 – 17/81/1

Israel grid: 1980 1716

UTM grid: 7362 5693

Elevation: 51 m b.s.l.

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

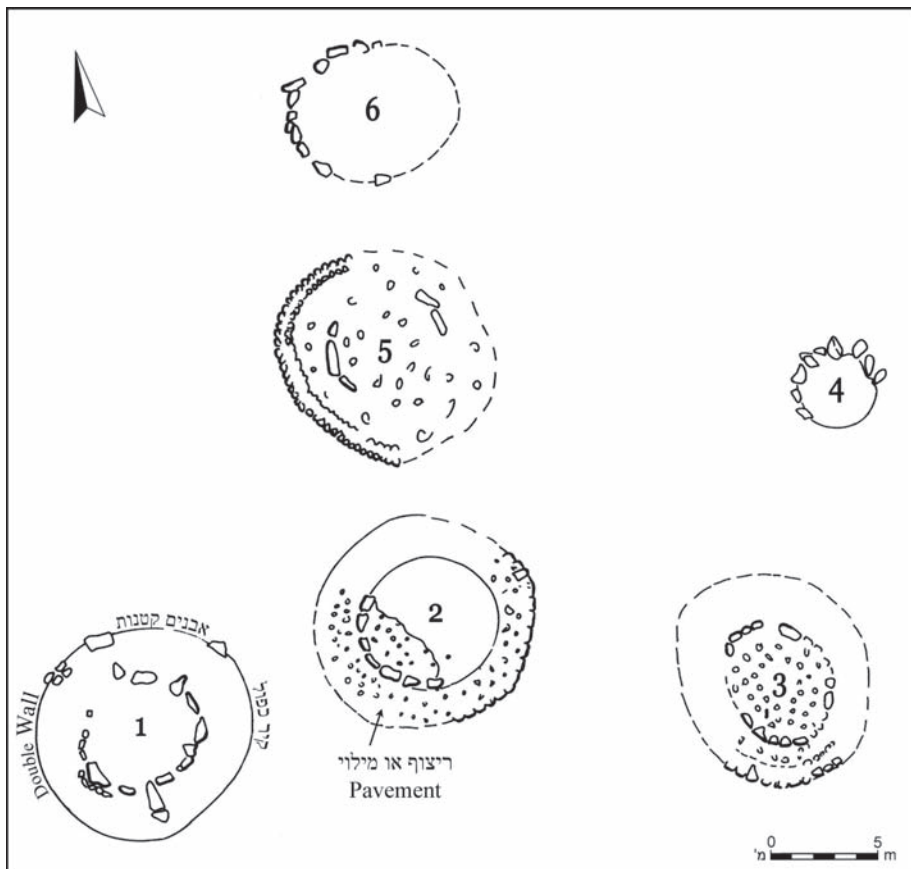
no shards but flints.

A site on the plateau on the southeastern edge of Ras el-Kharrubeh, with the road from el-Makhruq nearby. There is view from there of Wadi el-Far'ah and the Jordan Valley.

The place appears to be a concentration of *tumuli* of various sizes that have been dismantled.

Flint find: middle Paleolithic.

Previous surveys: none.



550. Plan of the 267/9 site of *tumuli* in the heights of the Ras Kharubeh range.

Site 268: 19 – 17/63/1

el-Mas'udi

Israel grid: 1969 1733

UTM grid: 7356 5602

Elevation: 110 m b.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and structures

Area: 2 dunams (0.5 acre)

Topography: broad hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: brown-basalt soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

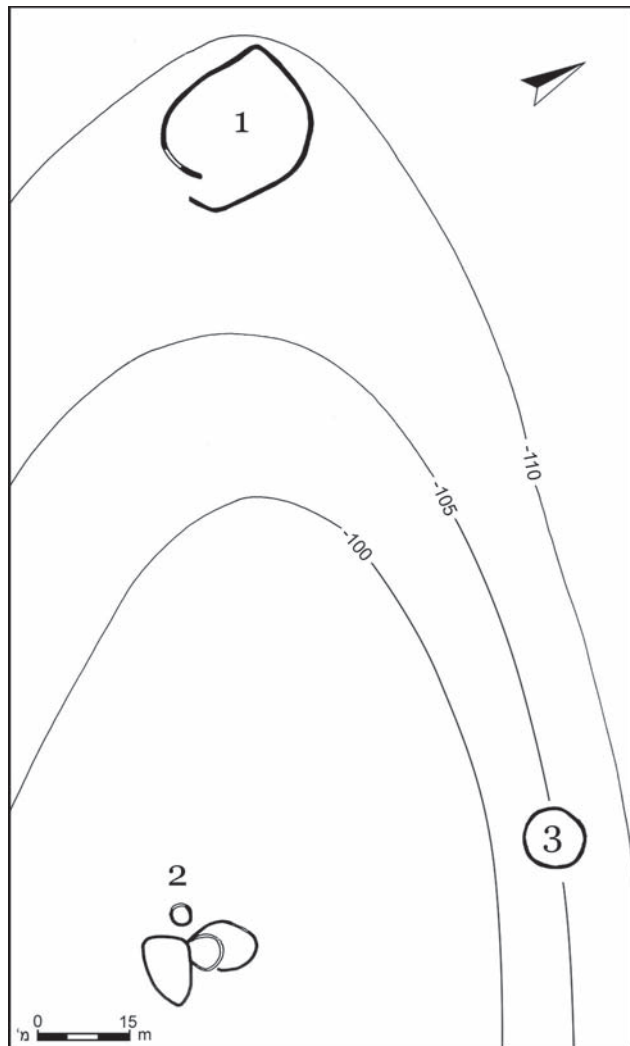
Cisterns: none

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah
(no. 104), 0.5 km distantNearest road: Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), 0.5
km distant

Visibility: 5

Jan. 28, 1994; 32 shards

551. Plan of the Chalcolithic Period site at el-Mas'udi. The Chalcolithic shards were found in the larger, western enclosure.



A site on a large, rocky hilltop in the southwest part of Ras el-Kharubeh.

The site is comprised of three parts:

1. A round enclosure 18 m in diameter, built of large stones, with an entrance in the eastern part. Around it is a shard and flint scatter.

2. 0.2 km east of the enclosure

is a *tumulus* with two adjoining courtyards.

3. 60 m north of no. 2 there is another stone-circle 10 m in diameter.

The relation between parts 1 to 3 is unclear.

Pottery: Chal – 100%.

Flint find: Middle Paleolithic and Chal; see appendix.

Previous surveys: none.



Site 269: 19 – 17/80/1

el-Makhruq (Guérin: Kh. Makherouk)

Israel grid: 1983 1707

UTM grid: 7369 5575

Elevation: 247 m b.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: historic site on map

Site type: fortified enclosure city and fortress

Area: 45 dunams (11.25 acres)

Topography: broad ridge

Rock type: 'Avdat formation

Soil type: rocky-stony soil; quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Nearest water source: Wadi el-Far'ah (no. 104), 1 km distant

Nearest road: Tel el Far'ah – Jiftliq (B3), and Jericho – Tel el-Hammeh (B10), passes by site

Visibility: 4

Nov. 19, 1993 and additional visits; 170 shards and 88 flint items

A large, fortified site on the decent from el-Makhruq into the valleys of Wadi el-Far'ah and the Jordan. The place has suffered from both archaeological excavations and destructive activities of the IDF.

The site consists of at least four parts:

1. A fortified city from the Early Bronze Age, which covered the entire area of the ridge. According to

the excavated finds, the city was triangular in shape with one corner pointing north. A large, fortified tower of red bricks, approached from the north by means of stairs, was found here with three architectural stages. In the center of the site (Area B-C of the excavations, cf. bibliography) parts of the residential quarter were exposed. In addition, the city wall of the Early

Bronze Age was discerned, with four consecutive levels of settlement, all from Early Bronze Age II-III.

2. Fortresses from Iron Age II. The northern of the two is square-shaped and is on top of the Early Bronze fortress. The central one is circular and is composed of three concentric circles, with inner division into cells.

3. A tell with a large, rectangular fortress on it, in the eastern, lowest part of the site. The fortress is built on top of the Early Bronze city and is surrounded by a particularly wide (about 4 m) stone wall. This fortress was also built during Iron Age II (and cf. now Zertal 2005 - Vol. IV, site no. 73).

4. Cave dwellings in the southern part of the site, with built courtyards in front of them. Agricultural installations were found there.

Pottery: Chal – 4%; EBA I – 5%; EBA II-III – 65%; MBA IIB – 2%; IrA II – 24%.

Special find: ceramic head of female figurine, IrA II.

Flint find: Pottery Neolithic, Wadi Rabbah stage; Chal and EBA; see appendix.

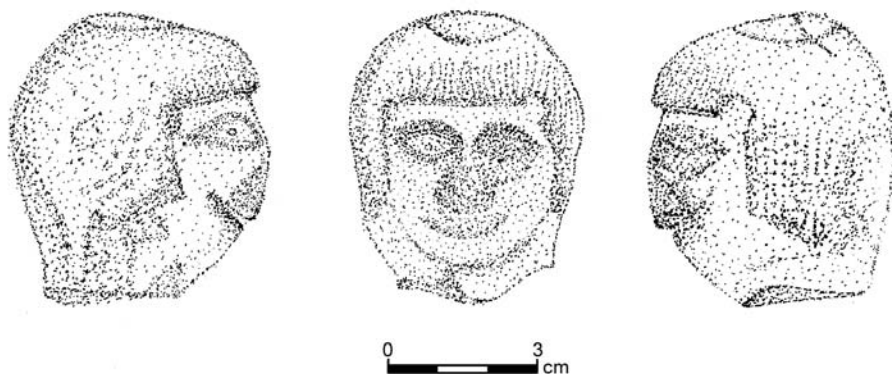
Previous surveys: Bar-Adon 1972, no. 4.

Excavation reports: Yeivin 1992; Yeivin and Eisenberg 1992.

Bibliography: Guérin 1969 (IV), 235-238.



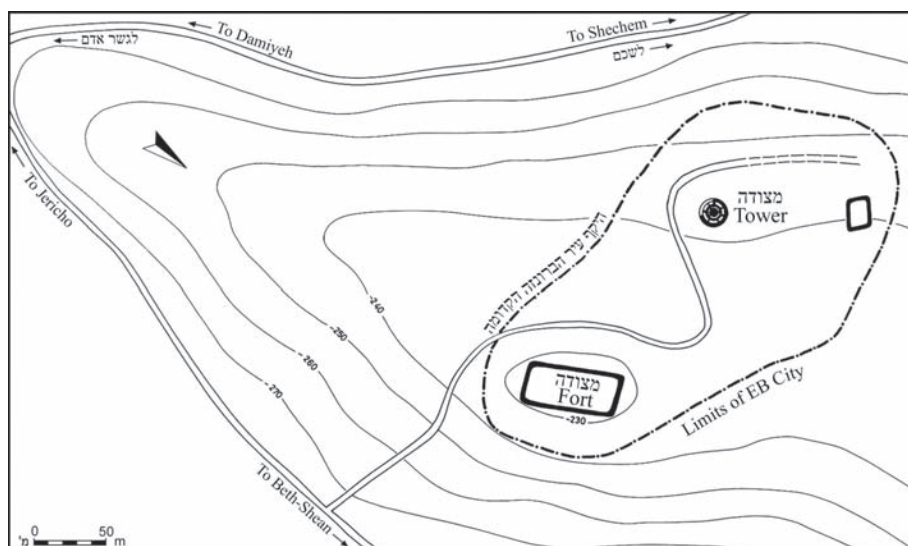
552. View to the north of the round, Iron Age II fortress at el-Makhruq, excavated by Yeivin and Eisenberg in 1974.



553. Three views of the figurine head of Ammonite type from el-Makhruq. It was found on the eastern fortress and is apparently from Iron Age II.



554. View to the east of the rectangular, Iron Age II fortress, built on the eastern hilltop of el-Makhruq (where the figures stand). The plains of Jordan Valley are visible in the background.



555. Plan of the site. The dotted line marks the area of the Early Bronze Age city. The Iron Age fortresses (rectangular and circular) and the fortified, Early Bronze Age structure (at right) are also marked.



556. Aerial photo of the 'wedge' of el-Makhruq between the Jericho – Beth Shean road and the Jiftliq – Shechem road.

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BAR = *British Archaeological Reports*.

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PART THREE

APPENDICES AND INDICES

APPENDIX A

FLINT FINDINGS IN EAST MANASSEH

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Preface for the English edition:

This appendix was prepared during the years 1993-1994 and published in Hebrew (Winter 1996). Since then further studies have been carried out in the Jordan Valley; the most important of these is Volume IV of the Manasseh Hill Country Survey which has been published in Hebrew (Zertal 2005). Accordingly, new data and new understandings on the studied area have been achieved. None of these data contradict the picture or the conclusions of this study; rather they just expand the scope and supply explanations for some problems which were not fully clarified in Volume II. Thus it was decided not to rewrite the appendix but to present some updates for several important issues in the prologue.

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Haifa, November 2006

Haim Winter

Introduction

The Manasseh Hill Country Survey started in 1978 with the aims of investigating and recording archaeological remains, the ecological situation and settlement patterns during historic and proto-historic Periods. The systematic and foot survey of large areas paid special attention to architectonic features and pottery shards which served as the main chronological indicator for dating the sites. Further attention was given to agricultural installations and the ecological background, but during the early stages of the survey the attention paid to prehistoric remains was still inadequate.

Special prehistoric surveys have been carried out in Israel – on Mount Carmel (Olami), in the Negev (Marks et al.) in Sinai (Bar-Yosef and Philips) and others as well. Despite the fact that the aims of the Manasseh Hill Country Survey were different and prehistory was apparently beyond its scope, over time, more and more flint artifacts were collected. They had to be analyzed in order to throw light on early human communities about which only little was known in the studied area.

Flint findings were a byproduct of the general survey and their collection was selective because of inadequate know-how of the teams at the time and the fact that attention was paid mainly to historic sites.

Small artifacts such as microliths and small debris were largely overlooked because of the difficulty of locating them without sieving.

This study tries to use the fragmentary lithic material in order to learn details about the presence of human communities during pre- and proto-historic Periods in the studied area. The potential for prehistoric research in the area is high considering that flint artifacts were found in another 50 sites published in this volume. These flint artifacts were not included in this appendix because they were either not indicative or their number was insignificant. Only sites with an appropriate and to some extent indicative, assemblage were included.

The fact that the survey was incomplete as far as flint findings are concerned dictated the scope of the analyses. Not all the technological and statistical aspects used for regular pre-historic research could be applied due to the fragmentary character of the assemblages. The scope of analysis for each site depended also on the quantity of lithic material in the collection; thus, the picture of the site does not reflect necessarily its actual importance in the frame of other contemporaneous sites in the area.

The aim of this study was to establish a general chronological framework for the flint assemblages

but in some cases it was impossible to distinguish sub-stages or local characteristics. During the years 1993/1994 the sites Khirbet Malih (C), Jelamet el-Ahmar (C), 'Iraq

el-Hamra and some of the Ras el-Kharube sites were surveyed thoroughly and larger quantities of flint artifacts were collected, resulting in a more detailed discussion.

General remarks on flint findings (raw material and shaped pieces)

A detailed investigation of the sources of raw flint (such as these for Levallois pieces or Cananean blades) or of the metric attributes of the artifacts was beyond the scope of the study. Nevertheless, some facts discovered by the survey should be mentioned.

In the area of Ras el-Kharube many spots and sites with finds from the Middle Palaeolithic Period were located. Close to these, lenses of raw flint were found, distributed at random in the lower layers of limestone from the Eocene Age (Zor'a formation). The colour of these Middle Palaeolithic flint artifacts without patina is light brown to gray-brown (a comparison to the Munsell chart was not carried out) but most surface findings show a light, tending to gray, spotted patina. During the Epi-Palaeolithic Period, apparently, the same flint was used but patination is only light or completely absent.

Some of the end scrapers were broken by snapping. Apparently, during the Epi-Palaeolithic Period, these end scrapers were deliberately

snapped, resulting in tools similar to thumbnail scrapers. All those pieces were counted separately. Occasionally some of the breaks could be post depositional and late.

Flint artifacts from the Neolithic and Chalcolithic Periods were mostly produced from light brown to beige coloured flint, sometimes with dark brown stripes or from coarse grained flint. Some of the axes from these periods were produced from semi-translucent, light brown flint. The sources of these flint varieties were not discovered.

Artifacts from the Wadi Rabah stage, at the southern part of the survey area (mainly sickle blades) were produced from dark brown flint to be found, perhaps, 10 km to the south, in the vicinity of Yafit (D. Nadel, personal information).

The fan scrapers from el-Makhruq were prepared from dark brown flint. The material, the preparation of the striking platform and the engravings on the dorsal cortical face are similar to those from Arad from Early Bronze Age II (Schick 1978).

Cananean blades were produced

from light coloured material apparently different from the local varieties. Even though no metric comparison was carried out, the impression was that most of these from the Early Bronze Age were shorter and narrower than those from the Middle Bronze Age I. Some Cananean blades were broken by snapping in order to prepare segments for composite sickles. In many cases these segments showed bi-lateral sickle sheen which serves as evidence that they were reversed in the haft.

Apparently fan scrapers and Cananean sickles were distributed by trade networks (Rosen 1989, 204, 209).

In many assemblages from the surveyed area there is a disproportion between the quantity of re-

touched tools and the quantity of waste. There are two reasons for this phenomenon. Firstly, the collecting was selective and no attention was paid to amorphous or small artifacts. The second reason concerns the retouch. Every artifact with regular uninterrupted retouch of 1cm in length at least is considered as a retouched tool; in some cases such retouch was post depositional and caused by natural forces or trampling of animals. Only in some cases, on patinated pieces, such late damage could be confirmed because the "retouch" had no patina. For these reasons, in most cases, no statistical analyses similar to those from excavated sites could be carried out and we had to rely on different parameters (see methodology below).

Methodology

Flint tools have served humanity from the dawn of prehistory and have continued through the historic ages until present times. In the course of the prehistoric research new procedures and typological lists were introduced as auxiliary tools and new technologies were applied. An identification based on typological considerations only has many disadvantages:

1. Different lists were prepared at different times for identical artifacts;
2. Quite a few artifacts do not

match any list;

3. Certain tools were used over long periods and are unsuitable for a chronological evaluation;
4. Regional or local varieties may not match generalized lists;
5. In some cases the typological and radiometric dates do not match (Hovers and Marder 1991, 51-53).

Faced with these problems, it was decided to rely on several sources for dating the assemblages. Whenever possible we used more than one source in order to verify the

dating. The available sources are listed below:

1. To a certain extent we used general type lists (Bordes 1961; Bar-Yosef 1970; Lee 1973), lists for specific tools such as arrowheads (Gopher 1985), sickle blades (Burián and Friedmann 1979; Gopher 1989a), reports from excavations and summarizing papers.

2. Technological and morphological features served as additional tools. Among these is the morphology of cores and the industrial waste; the application of the Levallois technique and the preparation of the striking platform; the application of the microburin technique; pressure flaking and application of Cananean blade technology.

3. At sites containing pottery a cross-check between the pottery shard assemblage and the flint assemblage was carried out. In cases when the flint assemblage contained artifacts used over different periods this cross-check helped to define the chronology. Examples of this are Cananean blades common in both Early Bronze Age and Middle Bronze Age I, and large geometric sickle segments, were in use from Middle Bronze Age II until the end of Iron Age II.

4. The composition of the tool and waste assemblages served as important evidence. Whenever no *type fossils fossile directoire* – pieces were present in the assemblage, the

character and percentages of tools and waste were checked carefully in order to enable dating. Khirbet el-Meiyiteh (no. 90) can serve as an example. At first, cores, end scrapers and burins, typical to the Epi-Palaeolithic Period, were collected but microlithes were missing completely. A new thorough search yielded the missing microlithes and lunates and the Natufian culture could be identified at the site. Similarly, at 'Iraq el-Hamra (no. 189), lunates were found only when the site was searched again.

5. In accordance with the available data the identification of the periods was divided into three grades:

- a. Highly reasonable identification
- b. Reasonable identification
- c. Possible identification.

Tools which served as *type fossils* and technologies which served for the identification:

Bifacial hand-axes served for the identification of the Lower Palaeolithic Period. Tools, which are similar to some extent, were found in Neolithic sites but these tools showed usually battered lateral edges (Olami 1984, 139, 151-152; Ronen 1984, 163 and figs. 10.29.1 and 10.30.1). No Lower Palaeolithic sites were found in the studied area.

Characteristic traits for the Middle Palaeolithic Period:

- The presence of the Levallois

technique at sites lacking hand-axes (see remark in the prologue);

- The preparation of the striking platform and the presence of *chapeau de gendarme* bases;

- The relative abundance of side scrapers;

- The relative percentage of the various tool groups (Bordes 1961);

The relative shares of blades and scrapers, burins and their morphology served for the identification of the Upper Palaeolithic Period. A single site from this period was found only on the fringe of the studied area and is not included in this volume;

The Epi-Palaeolithic Period was defined by the following traits:

- The morphology of cores and waste materials;

- The relative share and the morphology of the various types of microliths. The phases within the period can be defined by these traits:

- The morphology of end scrapers and burins.

Traits for defining the Neolithic Period:

- Bifacial tools – the axe, the adze, the chisel – and their special morphology;

- The presence of various types of

arrowheads;

- The presence of various types of sickle blades and reaping knives.

Characteristics of the Wadi Rabah phase:

- Typical sickle blades;

- The morphology of bifacial tools.

Traits defining the Chalcolithic Period:

- The morphology of bifacial tools;

- The morphology of sickle blades;

- The presence of perforated, discoid flint tools;

- The presence of fan scrapers.

The Early Bronze and Middle Bronze I Ages were defined as follows:

- The presence of Cananean blades and Cananean sickle blades;

- The presence of fan scrapers.

Middle Bronze II, Late Bronze and Iron Ages were defined by geometric sickle blades.

Studies dealing with flint tools and assemblages served as main literary sources for this work. They are listed in the bibliography below.

Discussion and evaluations

Flint assemblages from a surface survey are not sufficient in order to draw a full map of site distribution during the various periods. The picture, in accordance with the data at hand, is only fragmentary.

The absence of findings from the Lower Palaeolithic Period (except one possible handaxe) could indicate that during this period there was no human presence in the area. It should be considered that perhaps geomorphologic processes covered the remains from this period (see remarks in the prologue).

The Middle Palaeolithic Period is represented in the studied area by many sites and find spots of flint. Except for one single site, in the north of the studied area (Ras es-Salmeh, site 41) all the other sites of the period were concentrated in a clearly defined geographic location. Its center is the high peak of the Ras el-Kharube massif and the sites are dispersed on it and its fringes. The boundaries of the area (triangular shaped) are the road from Adam Junction to Mehola Junction at the east, the road from Adam Junction to Mehora Junction in the west and in the north the gorges of el-Jofe, Umm Kharaz and Abu Sidreh.

The number of sites and the quantity of artifacts point to a remarkable presence of humans during this period. All sites are open-air and no cave site was discovered.

Open-air and cave sites from this period are well known all over the Middle East. In Israel, clusters of open-air sites or find spots from the period were found on Mount Carmel (Olami 1984), the mountainous area in the central Negev (Marks and Freidel 1977) and at the fringes of the Judean Mountains (Schuldenrein 1978, 32-42). In the studied area all find spots from this period are located high above the surroundings and at some distance from water sources. The distance from the center of the mountainous triangle to the surrounding valleys is about 6-7 km, but most sites were closer to potential water sources in the gorges and valleys surrounding the Ras el-Kharube massif or to Lake Lisan (or earlier lakes) which flooded large parts of the area during the period. In any case the topographic structure was different than today's setting. It furthermore should be considered that the Middle Palaeolithic Period coincides with the last Ice Age or even the last Interglacial Period. At least during a part of the period the climate was different and less arid than today (Weinstein-Evron 1990).

Except for a single site located at the very edge of the studied area (to be published in Volume III of the survey, see also remark in the prologue) no sites from the Upper Pal-

aeolithic Period were found. Open-air sites from this period were found about 10 km to the south of the studied area in Wadi Fazeal (Goring-Morris 1980b). Unlike the situation in the mountainous area in the central Negev and Sinai where many open-air sites of this period were found, to the north such sites are few or absent (Ronen 1975). On Mount Carmel human presence is documented only in caves (Ronen 1974, 63). A possible reason for this situation in the north could be the deterioration of climatic conditions.

It is difficult to find *type fossils* of the Epi-Palaeolithic Period by a surface survey conducted on foot due to the small dimensions of many of these.

- No sites from the Kebaran culture, the first stage of the Epi-Palaeolithic Period, were found by the survey. It should be considered that in the lowlands of the Jordan Valley (a part of the Syrian-African Rift Valley) quite a few sites of this stage were discovered – from Ein-Gev (Bar-Yosef 1970) and Ohalo 2 (Nadel 1990; see also remarks in the prologue) in the north to Wadi Fazeal and Urkan er-Rub (Bar Yosef et al. 1974; Goring-Morris 1980a; Hovers et al. 1988) southwards. Possible reasons for this phenomenon are the mountainous terrain and higher elevations above the surrounding in the studied area and the climatic conditions which

continued from the previous Upper Palaeolithic Period.

Apparently the Kebaran was a direct continuation of this stage (Bar-Yosef 1970, 28; Gilead 1984, 227-229; see also remarks in the prologue).

- From the Geometric Kebaran culture the survey discovered two sites, both on hills above still perennial streams – Wadi Malih (no. 94) and Wadi Far'ah (Wadi Far'ah; no. 185).

- In similar settings two Natufian sites were discovered: in Wadi Malih (no. 90) located about 1 km upstream to the west and at Wadi Far'ah (Wadi Far'ah; site 189) to the east of the above mentioned Geometric Kebaran site. Two other sites were identified as possibly Natufian.

The locations of Geometric Kebaran and Natufian sites in the studied area are similar to those of other sites from these periods, close to water sources and flowing streams. To mention some of the sites in this situation: Einan (Perrot 1960; 1974), Hayonim terrace (Henry and Leroy-Gurhan 1976), Poleg M18 (Bar-Yosef 1970), Neve David (on the banks of Nahal Siakh, Kaufman 1987), Nahal Oren (Steklis and Yisraely 1963; Noy et al. 1973), Heftsibah (on the banks of Nahal Hadera, Ronen et al. 1975), Hatula (Ronen and Lechevallier 1985; Lechevallier and

Ronen 1994), D5 (in Nahal Zin, Marks 1976) and D16 Rosh Zin (Henry 1976). Some of the sites are directly on the banks of the streams – Einan, Neveh David and D5, while others – ‘Iraq el-Hamra (no. 189 in this volume), D16 Rosh Zin and Hayonim terrace were at some distance from the water source.

Artifacts from the Pre-Pottery Neolithic Period were discovered in three sites, two of them in Wadi Malih (nos. 83 and 90) and the third (no. 219) at Ras Umm Khu-beiza. The scarcity of artifacts from this period apparently points to limited human activity during this period.

Despite the equal number of sites the artifacts from the following Pottery Neolithic Period are numerous and indicative. Two sites in the Wadi Far‘ah (nos. 178, 179) were on two hills about 1 km apart. The third site was discovered at el-Makhruq (no. 269), a large multiple period site at the junction of Wadi Far‘ah and the Jordan Valley. All three sites were close to water sources, areas appropriate for agriculture, gathering and hunting.

In two sites (nos. 268-269), at the fringes of the Ras el-Kharube massif, tools of the Wadi Rabah phase were found. These are apparently a part of a group of sites from this stage in the Jordan Valley – Munhata (Gopher 1989a), Tel Tsaf (Gopher 1989b) and probably others. Some indications for this stage are

apparently found also in the Zababdeh Valley, in the northern part of the studied area (no. 4).

From the Chalcolithic Period onwards, and early historic periods, flint findings are represented only in a rather small part of the many sites from these periods. For full information about settlement patterns during these periods the reader should turn to the introduction of this volume.

The Chalcolithic Period is represented in all landscape units except Jebel Tammun.

Compared to the other periods, the number of sites from this period is high (nos. 4, 16, 29, 31, 32, 46, 90, 99, 189, 219, 229, 269). Some more sites were identified as possibly Chalcolithic (nos. 134, 169, 179).

From the Early Bronze Age the number of sites with flint findings declines and they are concentrated mainly in the area of Wadi Far‘ah (nos. 169, 178, 179, 182, 183, 189), and in two more sites (nos. 225, 269).

Middle Bronze Age I was identified in four sites, in the north of the studied area (nos. 66, 90, 232, 234).

Flint from the Iron Age was found in site no. 191 and possibly also in site no. 82.